



COLORADO SPRINGS

SAFETY ACTION PLAN

DRAFT - March 11, 2026

Prepared by **olsson**  **Next Phase
Engineering**





Mayor Yemi Mobolade

To my Colorado Springs Community Members,

As mayor, my highest priority is public safety — and that includes ensuring our transportation system is safe for everyone, whether you travel by car, truck, motorcycle, bicycle, on foot, or by transit. That is why I am proud to introduce Colorado Springs’ first Safety Action Plan, a bold, people-centered commitment to a future where every journey ends safely. This document reflects one of my deepest obligations as mayor: protecting the lives of those who call Colorado Springs home.

I consistently hear from residents that traffic safety and roadway conditions are top concerns. We listened, and we acted. Since taking office, we have made meaningful, measurable progress to make our streets safer:

- We added 10 new school zones since the 2023-2024 school year, with plans to add 12 more during the 2025-2026 school year, prioritizing the safety of our children.
- We deployed mobile safety speed vehicles to slow traffic in high-risk areas such as school zones, construction zones, and near parks (i.e., places where speed carries greater consequences).
- We expanded PhotoRed red-light cameras at critical intersections to support a broader enforcement of running red lights and reduce dangerous behavior at locations with high crash frequency and severity.
- Through the renewal of the 2C road repaving program, we secured a historic 10-year investment in safer roads, improving conditions today while preventing harm tomorrow.

This Safety Action Plan builds on this momentum and sets a clear, measurable goal: a 35% reduction, from 2023’s data, in fatal and serious injury crashes by 2035. Backed by a federal planning grant, this plan is rooted in local data, expert analysis, and most importantly, the voices of our community.

Our approach focuses on what works: smarter street design, safer speeds, education, and targeted enforcement. Because safety is not accidental, it is intentional. It begins with how we design our roads, how we share them, and how we look out for one another.

As mayor, I am committed to seeing this work through, not only because it is the right thing to do, but because it moves us closer to the city we aspire to be: safe, connected, compassionate, and ready for the future. Let’s stay focused. Let’s stay united. Let’s keep one another safe.

Onward and upward,

Yemi Mobolade

Acknowledgments

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Colorado Springs is committed to **eliminating** fatalities and serious injuries on our roadways.

Commitment from City Leadership

City leadership is fully committed to eliminating fatalities and serious injuries on our roadways. This Safety Action Plan reflects that commitment and serves as a unifying strategy across departments. The Mayor's Office and departmental leaders have all supported the development of this Safety Action Plan and recognize the importance of creating a transportation system that works for everyone.

Over the last decade, the City of Colorado Springs has laid a strong foundation for transportation safety through a range of adopted plans. ConnectCOS (2024) is a multimodal transportation plan for a safe, equitable, sustainable, reliable, accessible, and connected network. The Arterial Safety Study (2024) and Citywide Safety Study (2022) focused on historic crash trends and identified countermeasures and projects to address them. The City of Colorado Springs has also undertaken targeted corridor studies, implemented quick-build safety projects, and piloted speed management strategies. These efforts demonstrate a growing commitment to safer, more connected streets—and this Safety Action Plan builds directly upon that momentum.

Proclamation

City of Colorado Springs Commitment to Zero Roadway Fatalities and Serious Injuries

- WHEREAS,** the City of Colorado Springs and its regional partners are committed to protecting the lives and well-being of all roadway users—drivers, pedestrians, cyclists, and transit riders—regardless of age, ability, or transportation mode; and
- WHEREAS,** in 2023, the City of Colorado Springs Public Works Department, in pursuit of a safer transportation future, successfully secured a \$280,000 Federal grant through the U.S. Department of Transportation's Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) initiative to support the development of its first citywide Safe Streets Action Plan; and
- WHEREAS,** the City has undertaken a rigorous and data-driven approach to traffic safety, including an extensive crash data analysis and robust community engagement through the ConnectCOS Transportation Master Plan, conducted between 2022 and 2024; and
- WHEREAS,** in 2025, the City's Public Works and Traffic Engineering divisions are collaboratively developing the first-ever Comprehensive Safety Action Plan—an initiative that underscores the City's commitment to eliminating roadway deaths and serious injuries; and
- WHEREAS,** the U.S. Department of Transportation's SS4A grant program outlines "Leadership Commitment and Goal Setting" as a critical element in achieving meaningful reductions in traffic fatalities and injuries; and
- WHEREAS,** roadway fatalities and serious injuries in Colorado Springs have increased over the past decade, posing an urgent public safety and public health concern; and
- WHEREAS,** decisive and measurable action is needed to reverse this trend and move toward a safer, more equitable, and more livable city; and
- WHEREAS,** the City's Public Works and Traffic Engineering teams recommend adopting a bold interim target of reducing fatal and serious injury crashes by 35% by the year 2035, relative to the 2023 baseline; and
- WHEREAS,** this target serves as a vital stepping stone on the path to a long-term goal of zero traffic deaths and life-altering injuries, consistent with Vision Zero principles and national safety best practices.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED: I, Blessing "Yemi" Mobolade, Mayor of the City of Colorado Springs, on behalf of the City of Colorado Springs, do hereby affirm our unwavering support for the Safe Streets and Roads for All initiative and the development and implementation of the City's Comprehensive Safety Action Plan.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED: That the City commits to a 35% reduction in fatal and serious injury crashes by 2035 and to pursue continued progress toward zero, through data-driven strategies, community engagement, infrastructure investment, and interagency collaboration.

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED: That the Public Works and Traffic Engineering divisions are authorized and encouraged to lead this critical work, leverage all available resources, and keep the public informed and engaged in the shared mission of creating safer streets for all.



IN WITNESS WHEREOF, we have hereunto set our hand and caused the Great Seal of the City of Colorado Springs to be affixed this 18TH day of October 2025.


Blessing "Yemi" Mobolade,
Mayor, City of Colorado Springs

Glossary of Abbreviations

AASTHO – American Association of State Highway and Transportation Officials
ADA – The Americans with Disabilities Act
BUILD – Better Utilizing Investment to Leverage Development
CDC – U.S. Centers For Disease Control and Prevention
CDOT – Colorado Department of Transportation
CSFD – Colorado Springs Fire Department
CSPD – Colorado Springs Police Department
CTAB – Citizens’ Transportation Advisory Board
CYSHCN – Child and Youth with Special Health Care Needs
DOLA – Department of Local Affairs
EIAF – Energy and Mineral Impact Assistance Fund
EPCPH – El Paso County Public Health
HRN – High Risk Network
HSIP – Highway Safety Improvement Program
LOSS – Level of Service of Safety
LRTP – Long Range Transportation Plan
MDGP – Multimodal Discretionary Grant Program
MMOF – Multimodal Transportation and Mitigation Options Fund
MMT – Mountain Metro Transit
MOST – Motorcycle Operator Safety Training
MPH – Miles per Hour
NEPA – National Environmental Policy Act
NHSTA – National Highway Traffic Safety Administration
PPACG – Pikes Peak Area Council of Governments
RETAC – Regional Emergency Trauma Advisory Council
RMS – Revitalizing Main Streets
SAP – Safety Action Plan
SPF – Safety Performance Function
SS4A – Safe Streets and Roads for All
STBG – Surface Transportation Block Grant
STIP – Statewide Transportation Improvement Program
SRTS – Safe Routes to School
SVI – Social Vulnerability Index
TIP – Transportation Improvement Program
TIF – Tax Increment Financing
USDOT – United States Department of Transportation

Table of Contents

CHAPTER 1

1

Executive Summary

CHAPTER 2

3

Why the Safe System Approach?

CHAPTER 3

11

The Existing State of Safety

CHAPTER 4

33

The Design Toolbox

CHAPTER 5

45

Safety Strategies for COS

CHAPTER 6

49

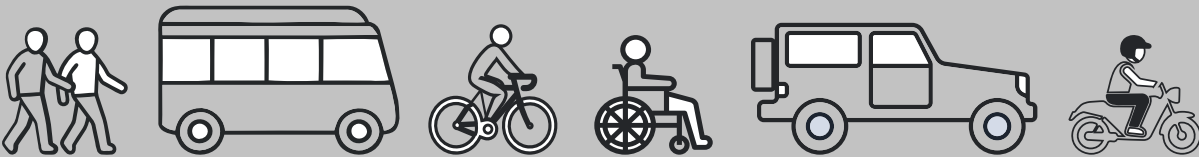
The Action Plan

APPENDIX A Engagement and Collaboration A1

APPENDIX B Systemic Safety Analysis Technical Memorandum B1

APPENDIX C Safety Countermeasures Toolbox C1

APPENDIX D Prioritized Project List D1



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY



This Plan provides a unified, actionable framework to make the City's streets safer for everyone. It reflects a strong commitment to proactive safety and community collaboration, and positions Colorado Springs as a leader in traffic safety innovation.

This Safety Action Plan (Plan) presents a comprehensive and strategic framework to reduce traffic fatalities and serious injuries across the City of Colorado Springs (City) transportation network. Funded through the federal Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) program, the Plan is grounded in the nationally recognized Safe System Approach that acknowledges human error and vulnerability and seeks to design a transportation system that minimizes the consequences of those errors.

Colorado Springs has **committed to a 35% reduction in severe traffic crashes (fatal and serious injury) by 2035**, relative to the 2023 baseline, with a long-term goal of achieving zero traffic deaths. This commitment is supported by City leadership and builds upon foundational planning efforts, including ConnectCOS, the Arterial Safety Study, and the Citywide Safety Study. These efforts have laid the groundwork for a unified and proactive approach to transportation safety.

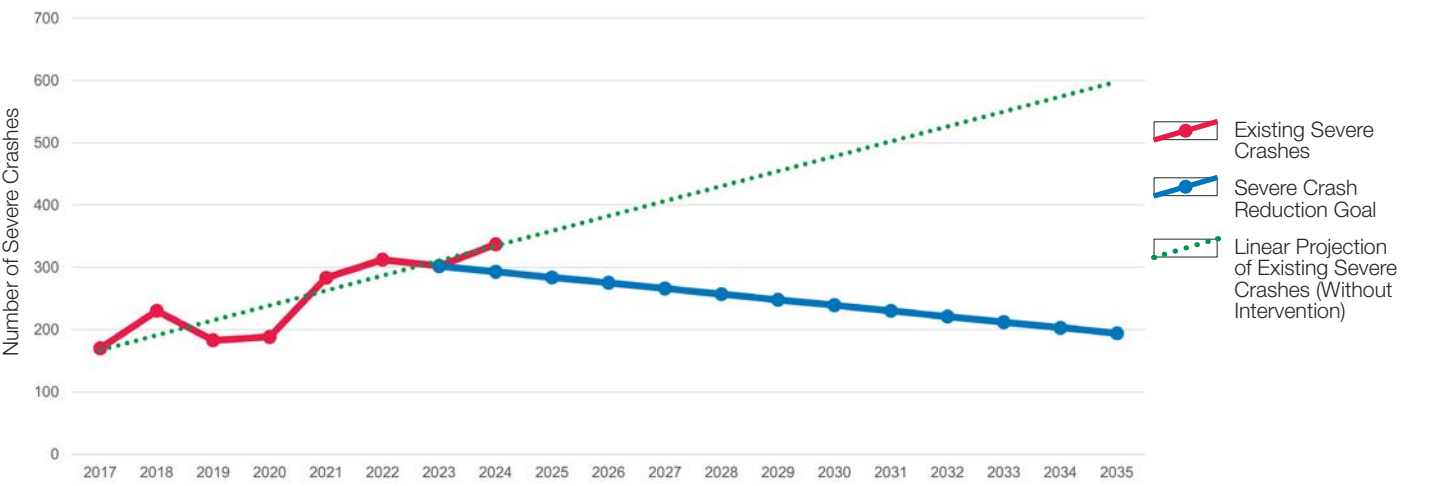
The Safe System Approach is central to the Plan and includes five core components: safe roads, safe speeds, safe vehicles, safe road users, and post-crash care. These components are reinforced by guiding principles that emphasize shared responsibility, proactive safety measures, and the preservation of human life.

While overall crash numbers have declined from 2017 to 2023, the occurrence of severe crashes is trending up. A systemic crash analysis revealed that these incidents are disproportionately concentrated on arterial roadways (e.g., primary roadways serving longer trips like Academy Boulevard or Nevada Avenue), in underserved communities, near transit stops, and within activity centers such as Downtown. Pedestrians, bicyclists, and motorcyclists are significantly more likely to be involved in severe crashes, with pedestrian crashes being nine times more likely to result in serious injury or death.

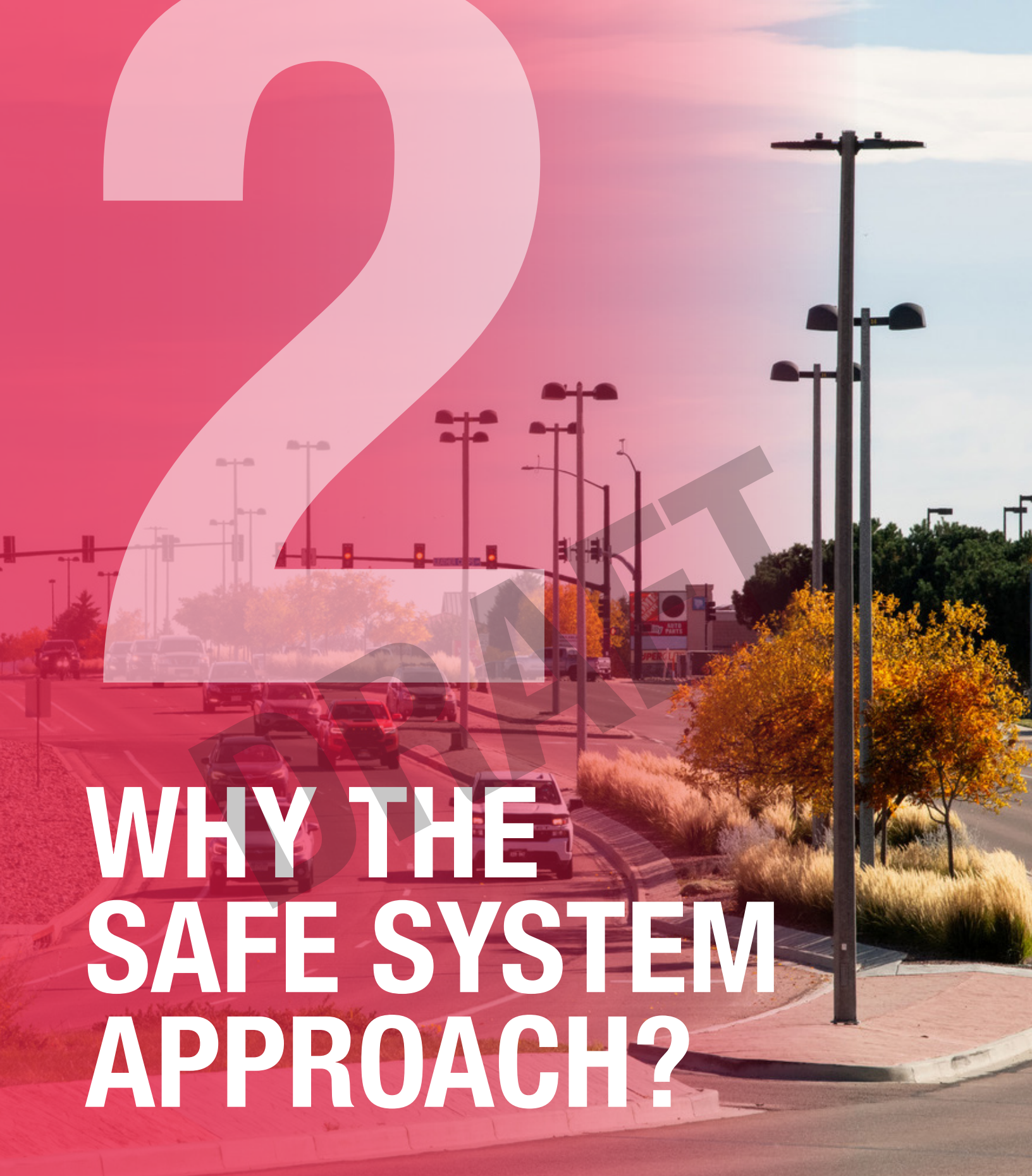
The City created several tools to identify locations for improvements including previously identified projects from other safety plans and identification of a High-Risk Network (HRN) for this Plan. This HRN comprises just 5% of City streets yet accounts for over 53% of all severe crashes. This network will be the focus of targeted interventions.

Other strategic actions are organized into three categories: policy changes, partnerships, and programs. Policy recommendations include updating design standards, implementing variable speed limits, and revising procedures for traffic impact studies to assess safety. Partnerships with schools, hospitals, advocacy groups, and military installations aim to foster collaboration and community engagement. Programs include Safe Routes to School and speed management initiatives. Taken together with projects, these interventions are designed to be applied in a layered approach increasing the likelihood of mitigating severe crashes.

FIGURE 1.1 Colorado Springs' Plan to Reduce Severe Crashes 35% from 2023 to 2035



Note: Severe crash data for 2024 became available during completion of the Plan.



WHY THE SAFE SYSTEM APPROACH?

Safety Action Plan and Safe System Approach

The Plan for Colorado Springs is a strategic, data-driven roadmap designed to reduce fatalities and serious injuries (severe crashes) on our roadways. This Plan is funded through the federal SS4A program, created under the Bipartisan Infrastructure Law to support communities in their efforts to improve traffic safety. The SS4A program encourages locally led efforts that prioritize community engagement and the implementation of proven safety strategies.

At the heart of this Plan is the **Safe System Approach**. This nationally recognized framework acknowledges that people make mistakes—and that the transportation system should be designed to prevent those mistakes from resulting in death or serious injury. It shifts the burden away from any one factor and toward a transportation system designed to prevent severe outcomes, even when crashes occur.

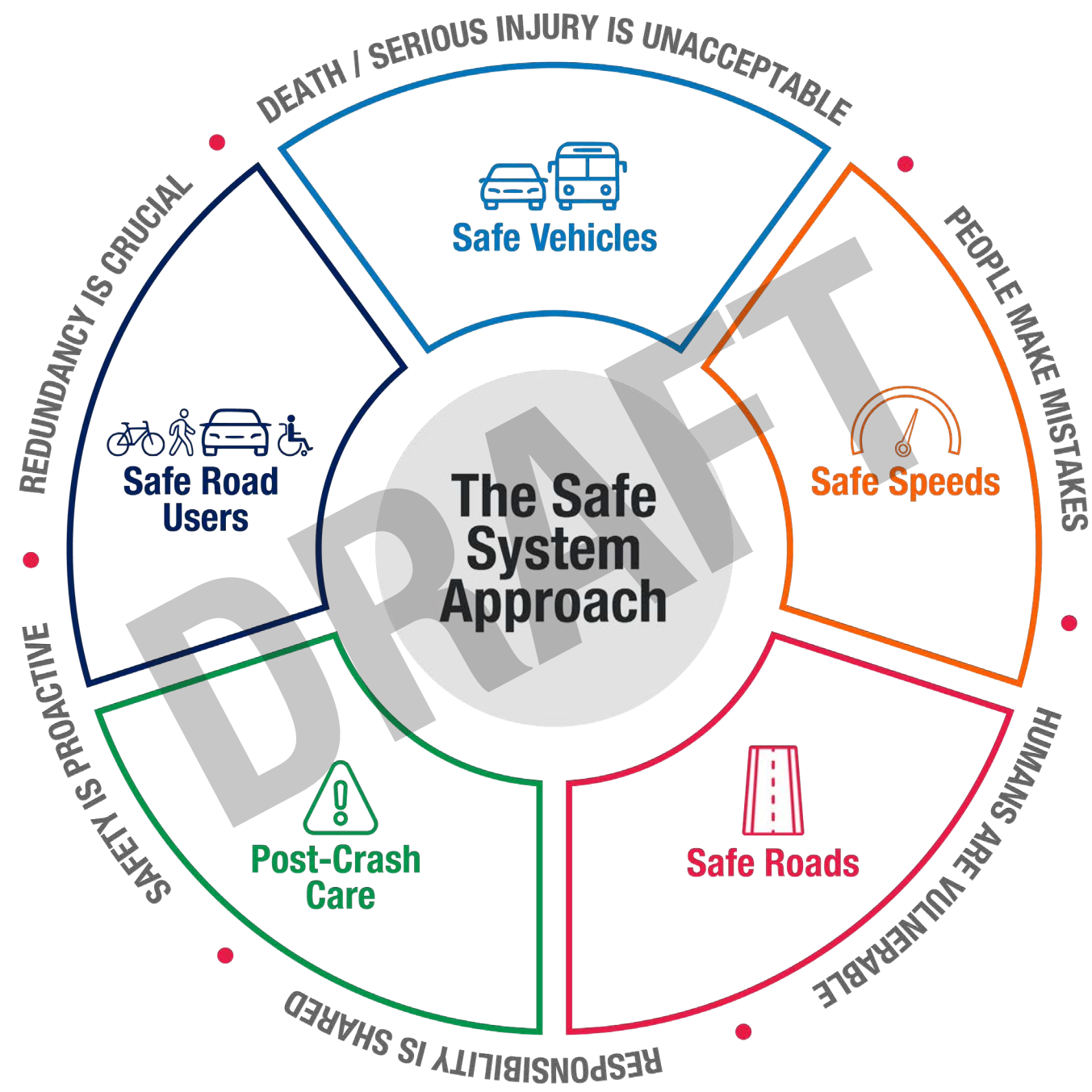
A Safety Action Plan's success lies in its implementation of the Safe System Approach because it acknowledges human vulnerability and error by designing a transportation system that minimizes the consequences of mistakes. It does so by abiding by its five core components:

- **Safe Roads:** Designing streets to prevent crashes and reduce severity when they occur.
- **Safe Speeds:** Ensuring travel speeds are appropriate for the context and user mix.
- **Safe Vehicles:** Leveraging technology and standards to protect all road users.
- **Safe Road Users:** Encouraging safe behaviors through education and outreach.
- **Post-Crash Care:** Improving response systems to save lives after a crash.

These components are bolstered by the six principles that state that traffic deaths and serious injuries are unacceptable, humans make mistakes, humans are vulnerable, redundancy is crucial, safety is proactive, and responsibility is shared. By enacting the Safe System Approach, agencies can take a proactive approach to improving safety on their streets.

This nationally recognized framework acknowledges that people make mistakes—and that the transportation system should be designed to prevent those mistakes from resulting in death or serious injury.

FIGURE 2.1 Safe System Approach Graphic



Source: Federal Highway Administration

What is Safe Streets and Roads for All?

The SS4A program provides **federal funding** to support local initiatives to **prevent roadway deaths and serious injuries**. SS4A supports planning, demonstration, and implementation projects. For Colorado Springs, the SS4A grant supports the creation of this Plan, which brings together existing planning efforts, identifies system-level risks, and builds a framework for targeted investments to improve traffic safety.

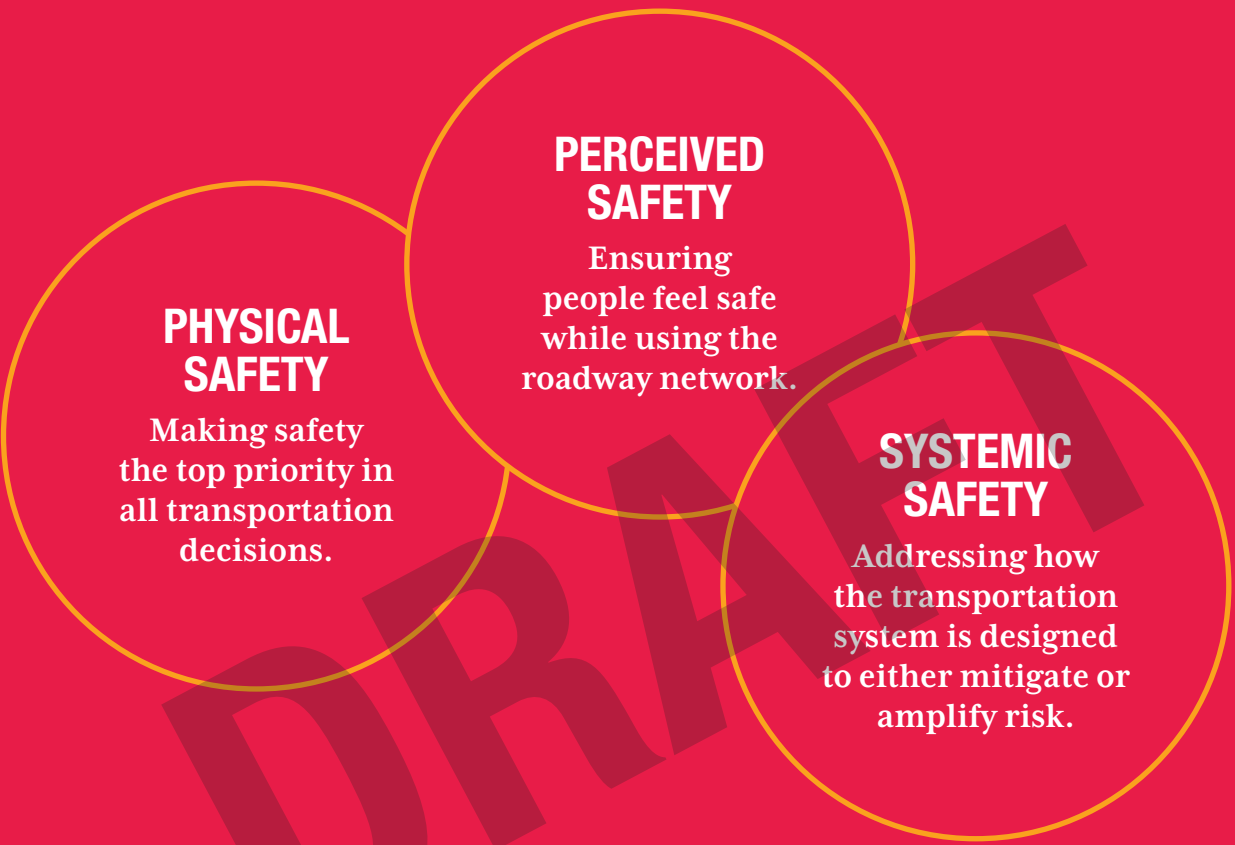
The program places a strong emphasis on speed management, bicycle and pedestrian safety, engagement, and the implementation of the Safe System Approach. It enables communities to take proactive, not reactive, steps in addressing safety challenges.

The seven policy principles, shown below, guide this Plan.

- SAFETY FIRST**
Safety is the top priority in all transportation.
- PRESERVATION OF HUMAN LIFE**
No loss of life is acceptable on our roadways.
- MISTAKES ARE INEVITABLE**
The system should prevent mistakes from resulting in fatalities or serious injuries.
- SHARED RESPONSIBILITY**
Safety is a shared duty between the public, agencies, designers, and decision-makers.
- PROACTIVE MINDSET**
Prevention is more effective than reaction. Intervene before crashes occur.
- DATA-DRIVEN DECISIONS**
Use crash data, risk factors, and community input to guide actions.
- COMMUNITY VOICE MATTERS**
Strategies should be shaped by public engagement and lived experience.

Defining Safety

Safety means more than crash statistics. In this Plan, we look at safety through three lenses:



All three dimensions matter. Infrastructure that is not designed for all users increases the chances of severe outcomes. This Plan seeks to address all forms of safety, especially in areas where risk is highest.



The Mission and Purpose

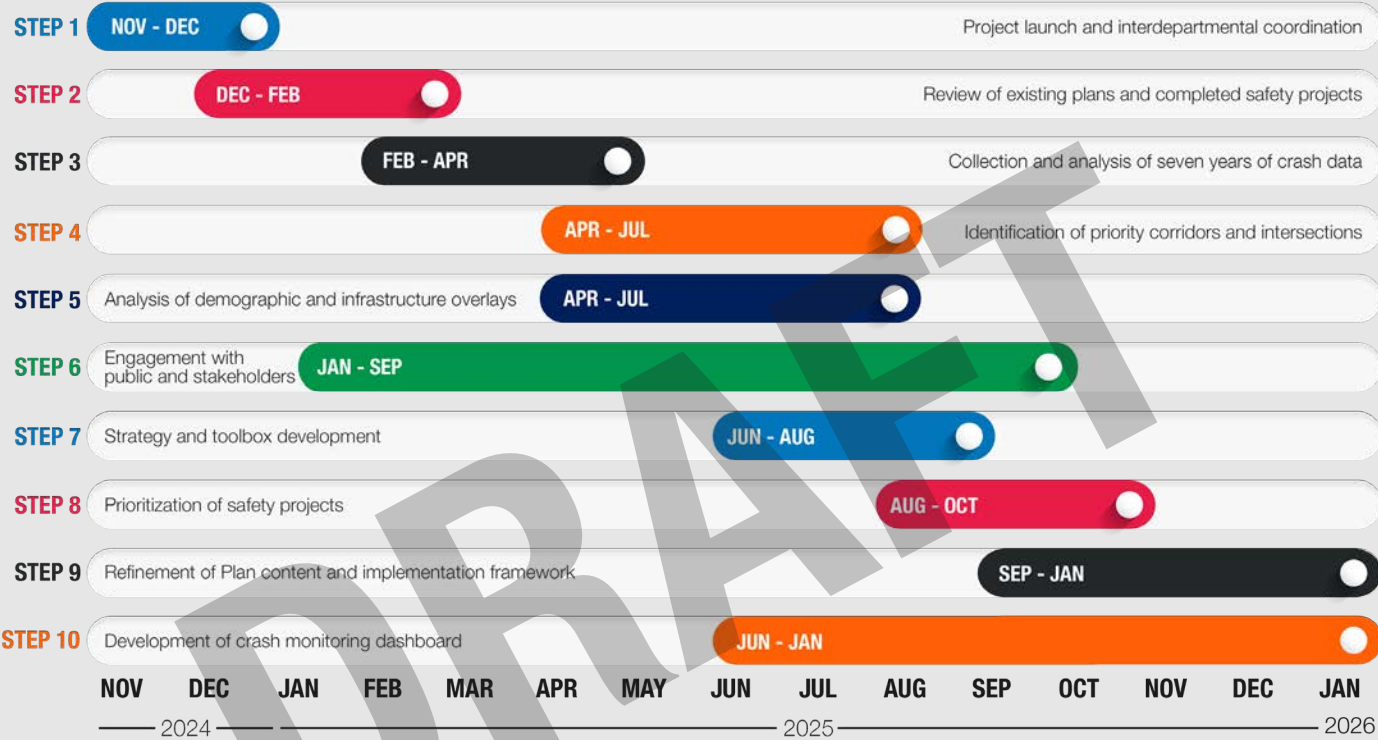
This Plan’s mission is to steadily and permanently reduce fatalities and serious injuries on our roadways. Through data-driven analysis and the Safe System Approach, the City is building a transportation system that puts safety above all else.

This Plan provides a framework for prioritizing safety improvements across Colorado Springs. It brings together past planning efforts, identifies the city’s highest-risk locations, and outlines a coordinated strategy to reduce fatal and serious injury crashes. It is both a policy document and an action guide, designed to direct investments, shape decisions, and ensure safety is centered in every project moving forward.



The Process

The development of this Plan followed a step-by-step process that combined technical analysis with local knowledge. Each step was designed to ensure the final Plan is both technically sound and deeply rooted in community priorities. The process built on the City's momentum, while identifying gaps that need to be addressed. The result is a coordinated strategy to eliminate fatalities and serious injuries on our roadways—one that can adapt and grow as conditions and needs evolve.



Stakeholder and Public Engagement Highlights

Note: Input received from all engagement activities is included in **Appendix A**.

 **2 Stakeholder Group Meetings**
April 30, 2025 and September 17, 2025

 **4 Working Group Meetings**
December 18, 2024, February 27, 2025, July 10, 2025, and October 23, 2025

 **5 Public Outreach Tabling Events**
June 7, 2025 - Get Outdoors Day / June 8, 2025 - Southeast Colorado Springs Farmer's Market
June 18, 2025 - Sand Creek Library / June 22, 2025 - Southeast Colorado Springs Farmer's Market
June 26, 2025 - CommUnity Meeting

The Plan Structure

The next sections of this Plan include:

Existing Safety Performance and Plans

A look at past efforts and crash trends that inform this work.

Engagement Summary

Key insights from the community and how public input shaped the Plan.

Safe System Toolbox

A collection of countermeasures Colorado Springs can use to address the most pressing safety challenges.

Selection of Countermeasures

A determination of strategies to be used at priority locations, whether as part of a capital project or through a systemic application.

Implementation Plan

A complete list of projects, policies, and programs prioritized on their relative need.



The Current State of Safety

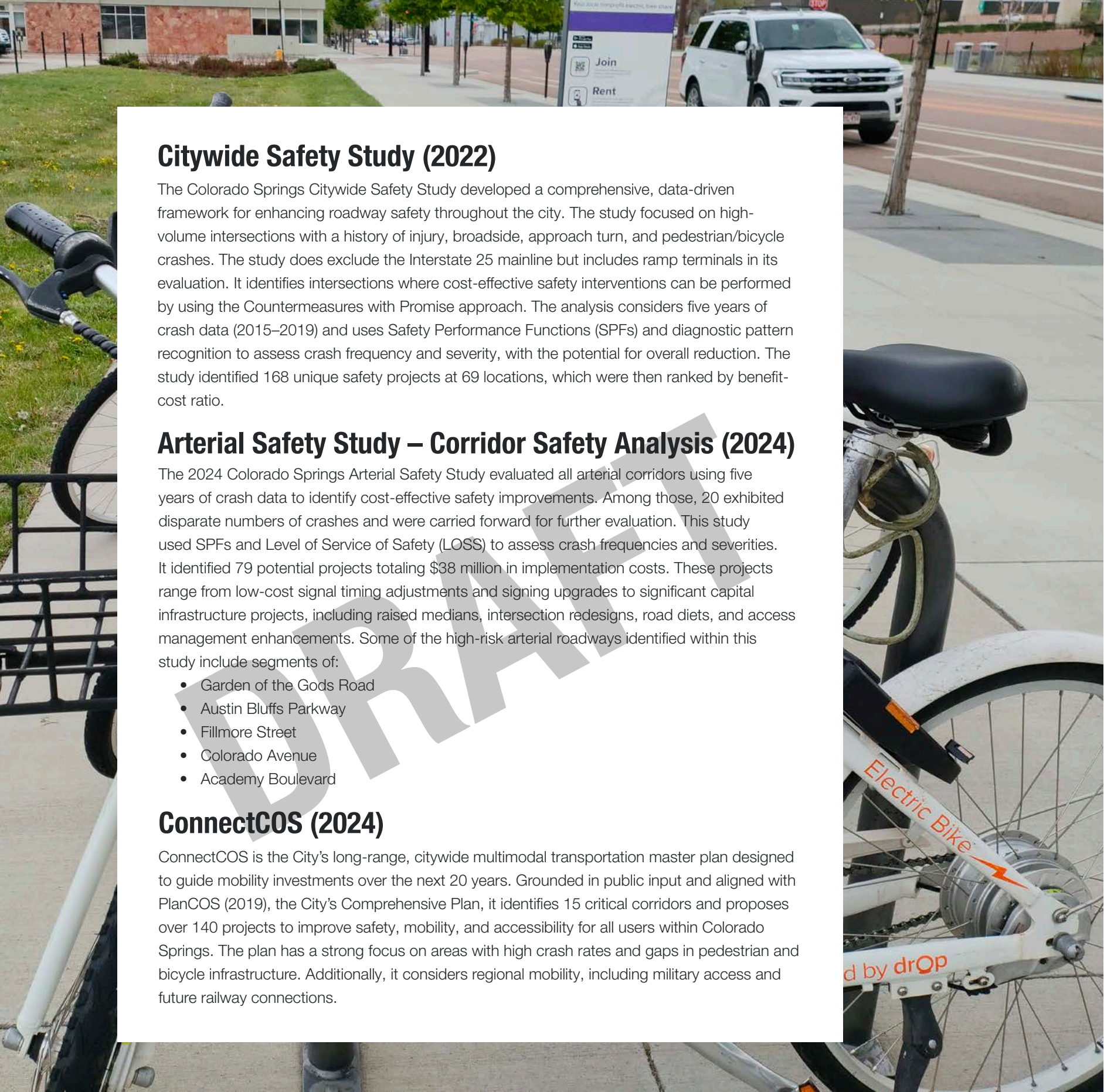
The City of Colorado Springs conducted a comprehensive analysis of crash data across the city as part of the Colorado Springs Citywide Safety Study (October 2022) and the Arterial Corridor Safety Assessment (April 2024). “Data-driven” is a guiding principle of this Plan and indispensable to the Safe System Approach. This comprehensive, data-driven approach helps identify precise crash concerns linked to mode share, crash types, roadway characteristics, intersection types, and other behavioral elements that can be addressed. By merging this data analysis with the active involvement of the Safety Action Plan Working Group, the City of Colorado Springs has identified proposed areas for improvement and established projects and planned efforts to propel the City’s journey towards ensuring Safe Streets for All.

It is worth noting that only crashes on non-freeway facilities were analyzed. This is because the City of Colorado Springs has limited control of how freeway facilities operate (CDOT has primary jurisdiction). Additionally, the characteristics of freeway crashes are much different than those on local, collector, and arterial roadways.

THE EXISTING STATE OF SAFETY

Existing Plans

The City conducted several safety-related plans and studies before initiating the safety action planning process. These plans and studies provided an essential foundation for the analysis and conclusions presented in this Plan. These plans and studies range from data-intensive crash analyses to a citywide master plan and were supported by robust engagement and feedback from the community. A high-level overview of these plans and studies follows.



Citywide Safety Study (2022)

The Colorado Springs Citywide Safety Study developed a comprehensive, data-driven framework for enhancing roadway safety throughout the city. The study focused on high-volume intersections with a history of injury, broadside, approach turn, and pedestrian/bicycle crashes. The study does exclude the Interstate 25 mainline but includes ramp terminals in its evaluation. It identifies intersections where cost-effective safety interventions can be performed by using the Countermeasures with Promise approach. The analysis considers five years of crash data (2015–2019) and uses Safety Performance Functions (SPFs) and diagnostic pattern recognition to assess crash frequency and severity, with the potential for overall reduction. The study identified 168 unique safety projects at 69 locations, which were then ranked by benefit-cost ratio.

Arterial Safety Study – Corridor Safety Analysis (2024)

The 2024 Colorado Springs Arterial Safety Study evaluated all arterial corridors using five years of crash data to identify cost-effective safety improvements. Among those, 20 exhibited disparate numbers of crashes and were carried forward for further evaluation. This study used SPFs and Level of Service of Safety (LOSS) to assess crash frequencies and severities. It identified 79 potential projects totaling \$38 million in implementation costs. These projects range from low-cost signal timing adjustments and signing upgrades to significant capital infrastructure projects, including raised medians, intersection redesigns, road diets, and access management enhancements. Some of the high-risk arterial roadways identified within this study include segments of:

- Garden of the Gods Road
- Austin Bluffs Parkway
- Fillmore Street
- Colorado Avenue
- Academy Boulevard

ConnectCOS (2024)

ConnectCOS is the City’s long-range, citywide multimodal transportation master plan designed to guide mobility investments over the next 20 years. Grounded in public input and aligned with PlanCOS (2019), the City’s Comprehensive Plan, it identifies 15 critical corridors and proposes over 140 projects to improve safety, mobility, and accessibility for all users within Colorado Springs. The plan has a strong focus on areas with high crash rates and gaps in pedestrian and bicycle infrastructure. Additionally, it considers regional mobility, including military access and future railway connections.

Other Ongoing Planning Efforts

In addition to the City’s transportation-related planning efforts, other regional and city-related plans and studies were also evaluated.

PlanCOS (2019)

PlanCOS is Colorado Springs’ comprehensive plan guiding development through 2040, structured around six vision themes: Vibrant Neighborhoods, Unique Places, Thriving Economy, Strong Connections, Renowned Culture, and Majestic Landscapes. The plan emphasizes walkable, connected communities with diverse housing options, multimodal transportation, and integrated infrastructure for stormwater management, parks, and transit. PlanCOS prioritizes reinvestment in high-risk corridors and areas, such as Southeast Colorado Springs, and supports safety improvements through complete streets and multimodal corridors. It also promotes environmental resilience, cultural identity, and economic development through innovation districts and military partnerships. PlanCOS is adaptable, with performance tracking and community engagement shaping its implementation.

Pikes Peak Area Council of Governments Serious Crash Study (2024)

The Pikes Peak Area Council of Governments (PPACG) study highlights the need to address rising risky driving behaviors—such as speeding and aggression—that have worsened since 2020, contributing to more severe crashes. The study concludes with methods to prioritize pedestrian safety through infrastructure improvements such as crosswalks, curb extensions, and better signing, while also recommending enhanced snow and ice removal for winter accessibility. Other key strategies include boosting seatbelt use through public awareness campaigns, expanding secure bicycle parking facilities, and strengthening micro transit services with improved infrastructure and tracking tools. The study emphasized that community engagement and updated policy measures are central to implementing these modernized safety countermeasures effectively.

Pikes Peak Region Safety Action Plan (2025)

The Pikes Peak Region Safety Action Plan process kicked off shortly after the Colorado Springs Safety Action Plan process began. PPACG received a federal grant from the U.S. Department of Transportation’s SS4A grant program to develop a safety action plan that would focus on El Paso, Teller, and Park counties. The City of Woodland Park administered the federal grant, with PPACG leading the regional planning effort.

The Project Team collaborated closely with PPACG professionals to align and maximize opportunities for coordination. The City’s goal to reduce severe crashes by 35% by 2035 complements PPACG’s region-wide goal to reduce fatalities and serious injuries by 50% by 2040, reflecting our shared commitment to Safe Streets for All.

Colorado Springs 2050 Regional Transit Plan (2024)

The Colorado Springs 2050 Regional Transit Plan outlines a comprehensive vision to expand and modernize transit services across the Pikes Peak region, emphasizing accessibility, equity, and technology. Key initiatives include the creation of six on-demand innovative mobility zones, enhanced transit corridors, new fixed and cross-town routes, and improved service frequency and span. The plan recommends that safety concerns should be addressed through infrastructure investments, such as Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)-compliant bus stops, improved lighting, enhanced transfer locations, and upgrades to improve speed and reliability. The Regional Transit Plan also prioritizes real-time information systems, contactless fare payment, and zero-emission buses, with phased implementation strategies through 2050 and a financial model to support both constrained and unconstrained funding scenarios.

PPACG Pikes Peak Region 2050 Long Range Transportation Plan (2024)

The Pikes Peak Region 2050 Long Range Transportation Plan (LRTP), developed by PPACG, is a comprehensive, forward-looking strategy for the Pikes Peak Region that integrates federal and state planning requirements and aligns with the Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act. It emphasizes a sustainable, multimodal transportation system that enhances safety, mobility, and quality of life, with a strong focus on reducing fatalities and serious injuries through data-driven strategies and targeted infrastructure improvements. The LRTP includes a list of 234 projects totaling \$5.5 billion, supported by a mix of federal, state, local, and private funding. Public engagement, environmental sustainability, equity, and emerging technologies are central to the plan, which also supports regional safety action plans and encourages the leveraging of federal safety funding programs, such as SS4A.

Experience Downtown Colorado Springs Plan (2016)

The Experience Downtown Colorado Springs Plan is a strategic update to earlier downtown plans, aiming to revitalize the city center through 2025. It envisions a vibrant, walkable, and inclusive downtown by focusing on multimodal connectivity, housing diversity, economic development, and enhancing public spaces. A mobility framework is a key feature of the plan, prioritizing pedestrian and bicycle safety, traffic calming, and transit improvements, which align closely with the SS4A program. The plan promotes the redevelopment of key sites, the integration of arts and culture, and the use of tools like tax increment financing (TIF) to support implementation. It addresses challenges such as homelessness and underutilized land while emphasizing equity, sustainability, and strong public-private collaboration.

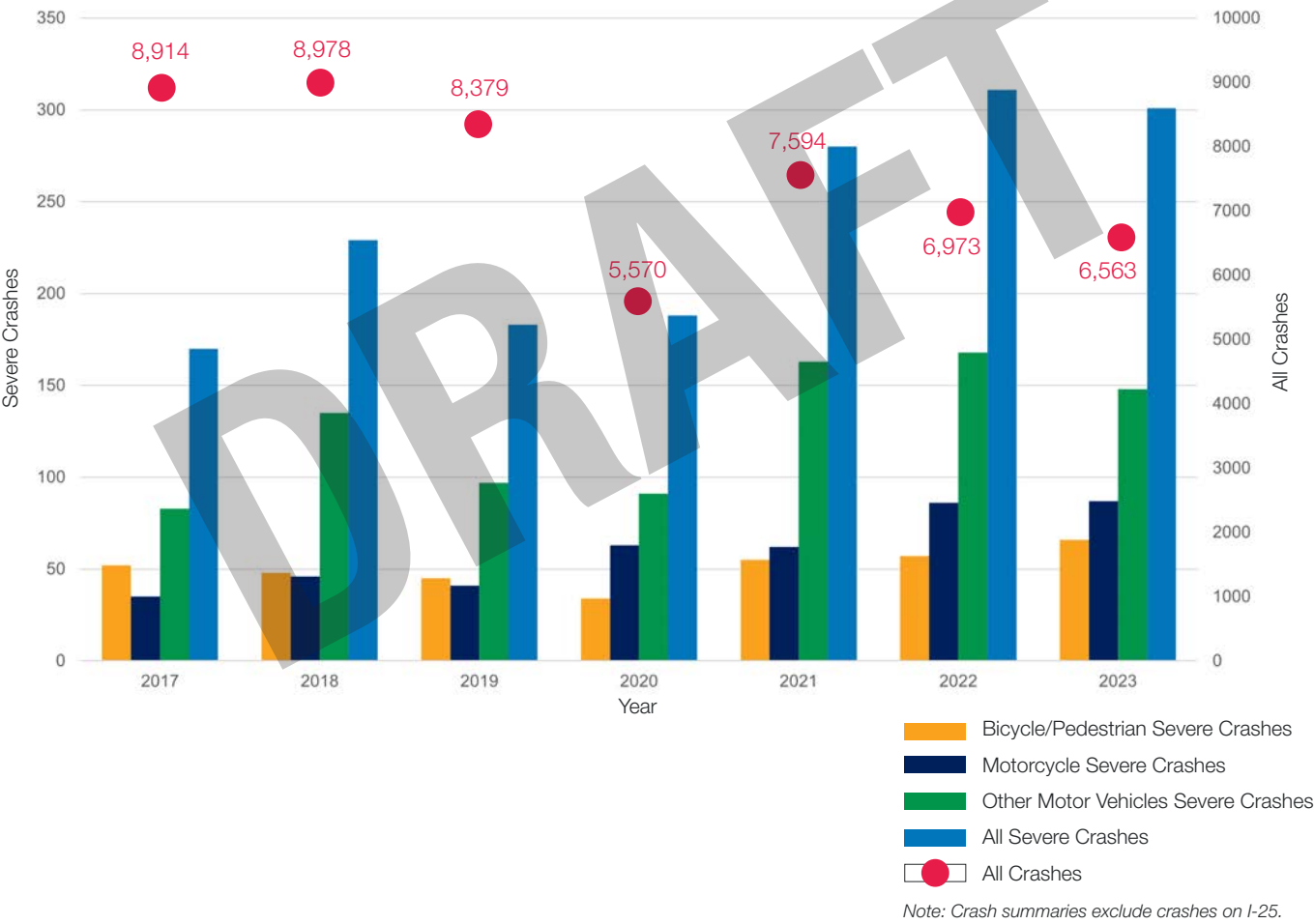
Colorado Department of Transportation Strategic Transportation Safety Plan (2020)

The 2020–2023 Colorado Strategic Transportation Safety Plan is a comprehensive statewide initiative aimed at reducing fatalities and serious injuries by 15% by 2023. It outlines 15 high-priority strategies that address high risk behaviors, vulnerable road users, and existing infrastructure. The plan promotes data-driven decision-making, the implementation of proven countermeasures, and collaboration among local, regional, and state stakeholders. It includes performance targets and emphasizes the importance of local agency involvement in the implementation process. Performance is tracked through annual safety reviews and progress metrics.

Historic Safety Performance and Systemic Analysis

The historic safety analysis reviews crashes between 2017 and 2023, focusing primarily on crash severity and the transportation modes of those involved. The data is reported by mode: bicycle (including e-bicycles), pedestrian, motorcycle, and all other motor vehicles. The Plan focuses on causes of serious injury (i.e., an incapacitating injury as determined by police at the scene) and fatal crashes, herein termed as “severe crashes.” Unfortunately, severe crashes have been increasing in Colorado Springs, despite a decline in the overall number of crashes. This underscores the importance of this Plan and the urgency with which strategies should be implemented.

FIGURE 3.1 Annual Severe Crash Trends by Mode (2017-2023)



Focus Areas

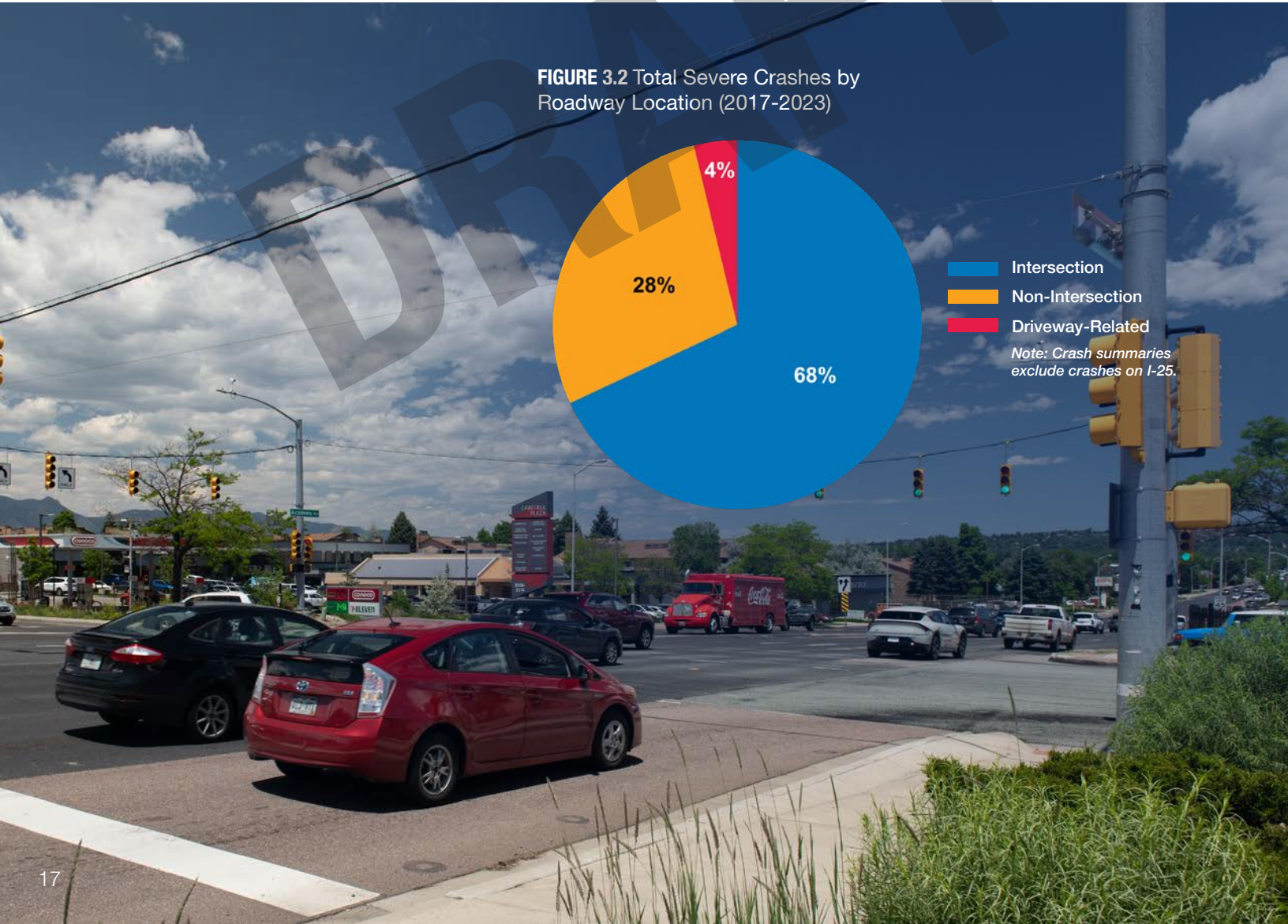
Seven years of recent crash data (2017-2023) were used to determine the types of conditions most likely to lead to severe crashes. These may include features of the infrastructure, the land use and demographics of the surrounding area, or characteristics of the road user. Attributes overrepresented in severe crashes were identified as Focus Areas, which include:

- Intersections
 - Crash Types
- Posted Speed
 - Impairments
- Pedestrian and Bicyclist Crashes
 - Motorcycle Crashes

While adverse lighting, weather, and road conditions typically correlate with severe crashes, Colorado Springs data did not indicate a significant correlation with these factors. Further explanation of this can be found in **Appendix B**.

Intersections

Most severe crashes (65%) on Colorado Springs roadways are intersection-related. Of the 1,135 intersection-related severe crashes that occurred from 2017-2023, seven occurred at roundabouts. The remaining 1,128 intersection-related severe crashes occurred at or around signalized or stop-controlled intersections. It must be noted that crashes that occur at driveways are not included as “intersection-related” crashes and are categorized separately.



Crash Types

The most frequent and severe types of vehicle-to-vehicles crashes observed along Colorado Springs’ roadways are approach turn crashes and broadside crashes. Approach turn crashes occur at intersections when a through-moving vehicle collides with a vehicle making a left turn from the opposite direction. Broadside, or “T-bone,” crashes occur when a through-moving vehicle from a side street collides with a perpendicular through-moving vehicle.

These crashes typically result in high crash severities due to the high speed differentials, direct impacts to occupant areas, and limited vehicle protection compared to the more frequent rear-end crashes.

Pedestrian crashes are over eight times more likely to result in a severe crash. This phenomenon is discussed later in this Plan.

It is also worth noting while head-on, bicycle, and overturning/rollover crashes occur less frequently, when they do happen, they tend to result in severe crashes, more so than approach turn, broadside, or pedestrian crashes.

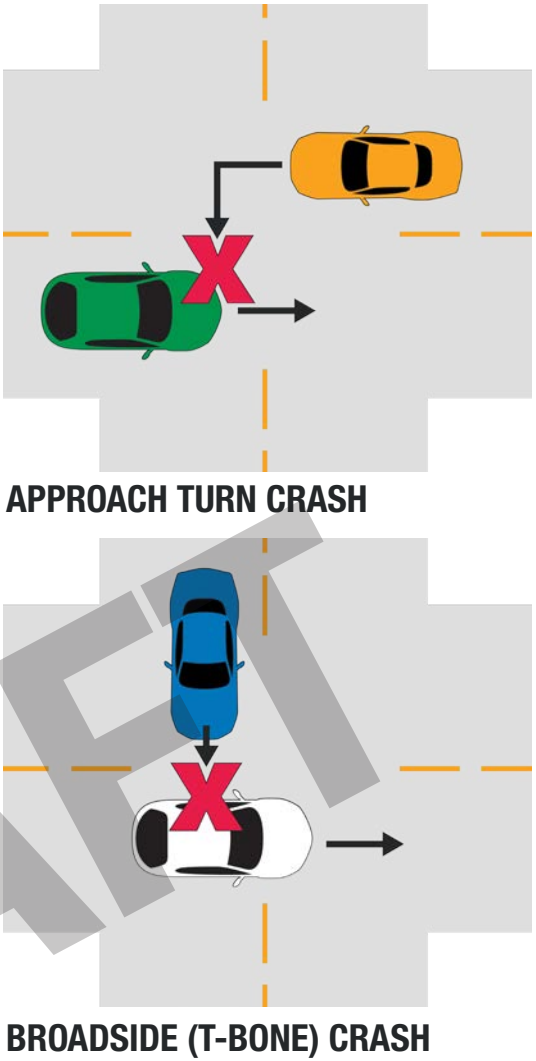
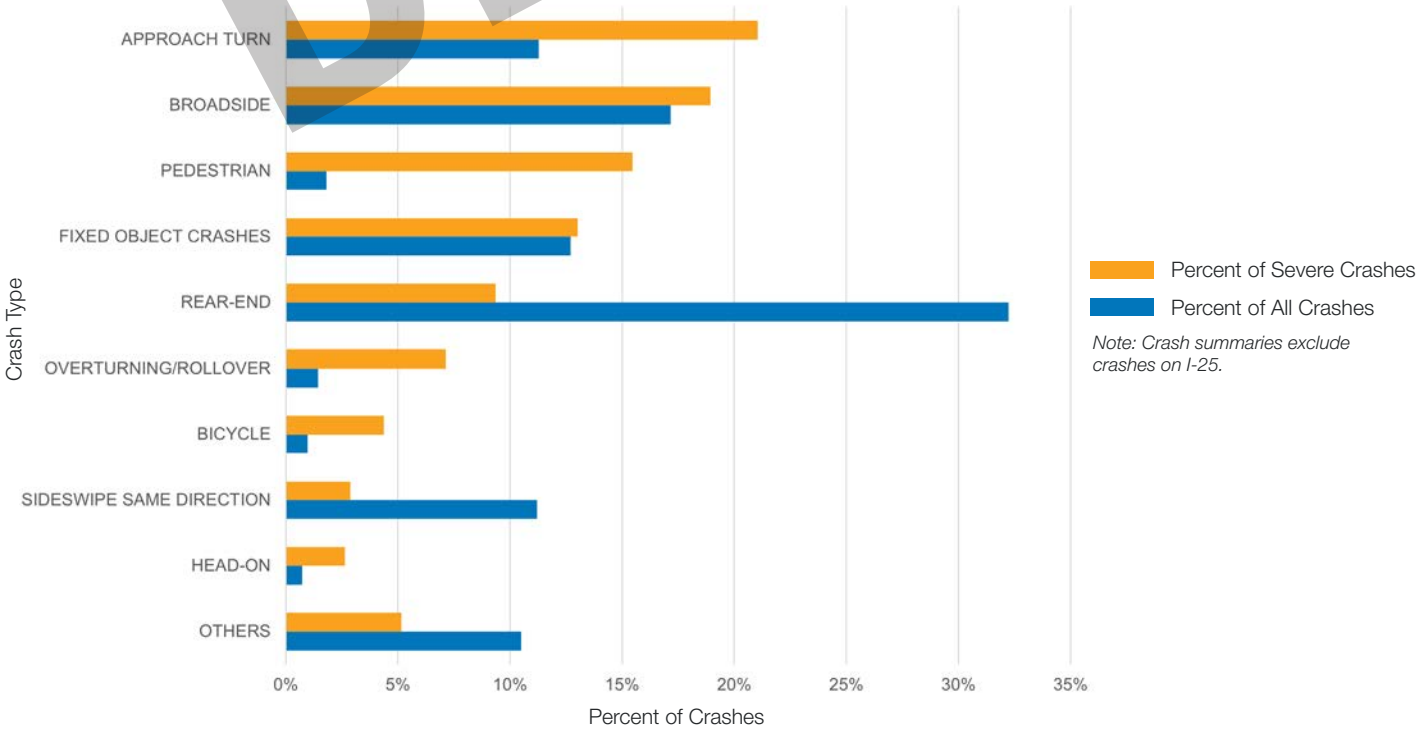


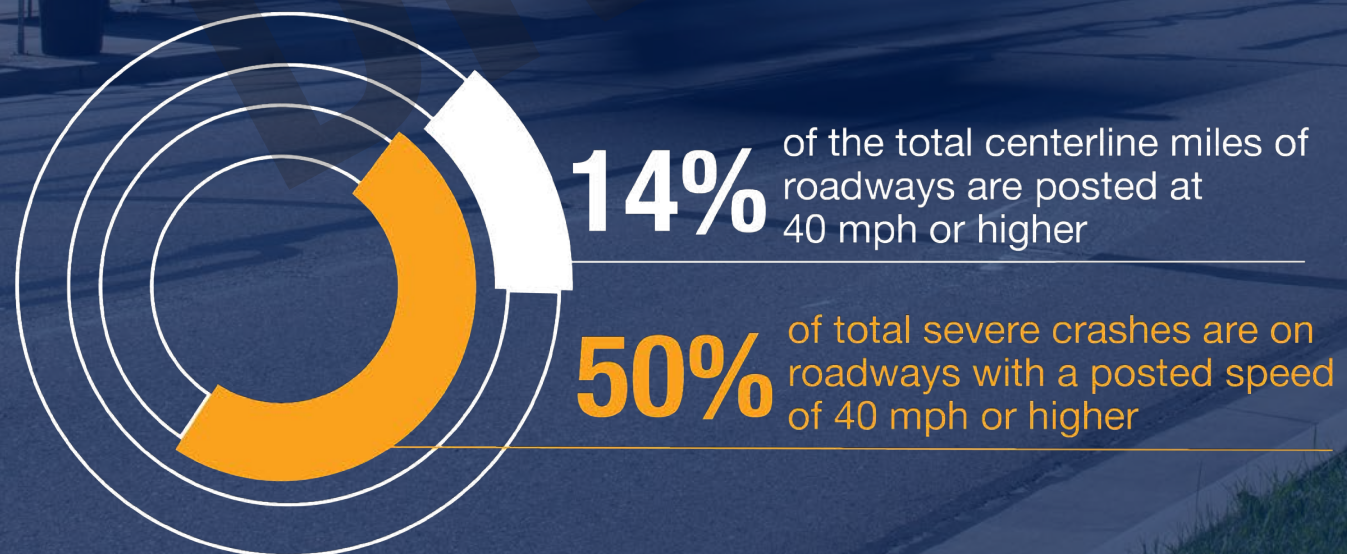
FIGURE 3.3 Percent of Crashes by Crash Type



Posted Speed Limit

Speed is one of the most important factors dictating whether a crash results in a serious injury or fatality. Of all severe crashes, 50% occur on roadways with a posted speed limit of 40 miles per hour (mph) or higher. This category of roadway accounts for only 14% of the centerline miles of road. This means there is also a higher density of crashes on roads with a posted speed limit of 40 mph or more. Both facts suggest a correlation between the occurrence of severe crashes and higher posted speed limits.

FIGURE 3.4 Speed and Crash Severity
Note: Crash summaries exclude crashes on I-25.



Impairments

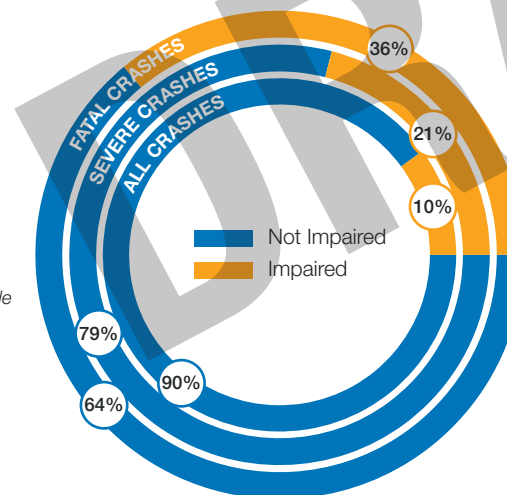
Drivers will always make mistakes, and the consequences can be disastrous. Some behaviors and choices can be considered reckless or even negligent and have an outsized impact on severe crashes. Driving while impaired by alcohol, marijuana, or drugs is one such choice.

Data in Colorado Springs show impaired driving to be a risk factor. Of all crashes, 10% involved driver impairment. For severe crashes only, that number increased to over 20%, and considering only fatal crashes, it is over 35%. The potential for a severe crash more than doubles when driver impairment is involved.

While driver inattentiveness (distracted driving) is often attributed to increases in severe crash likelihood, data regarding inattention as a major factor in severe crashes is not consistently recorded. This, combined with the limitations of both the crash report form and the ability of the investigating officer to determine inattentive driving, makes inattentive driving data too unreliable to report in this Plan.

FIGURE 3.5
Crashes by Impairment

Note: Crash summaries exclude crashes on I-25.



Pedestrian and Bicycle Crashes

If a pedestrian or bicycle is involved in a crash, it is, unsurprisingly, much more likely to result in severe consequences. The data show that historically in Colorado Springs the percent of bicycle and pedestrian crashes that result in fatal or serious injury are 15% and 27%, respectively. This is compared to 2% for motor vehicle crashes. The stark difference demonstrates the higher risk to pedestrians and bicycles. Note that this is also the case for motorcyclists, a topic discussed in more detail later in the Plan.

Most severe pedestrian and bicycle crashes occur at intersections because the most conflicts between motor vehicle traffic and pedestrians or bicycles most frequently occur here. The proportion of pedestrian and bicycle crashes occurring in designated bicycle facilities and sidewalks is relatively low. Fewer than 48% of all bicycle crashes occur within bicycle facilities, and fewer than 3% of all pedestrian-related crashes occur on sidewalks.

CRASHES INVOLVING
PEDESTRIANS OR BICYCLES ARE
7X MORE LIKELY THAN MOTOR VEHICLE
CRASHES TO RESULT IN
SEVERE INJURY OR FATALITY

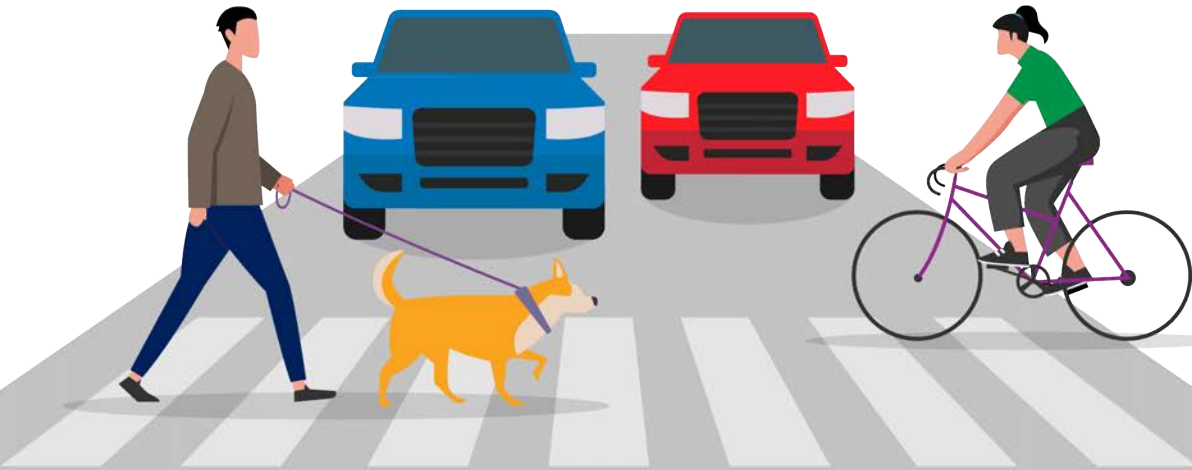


FIGURE 3.6 Severe Crash Occurrence by Mode (2017-2023)
Note: Crash summaries exclude crashes on I-25.

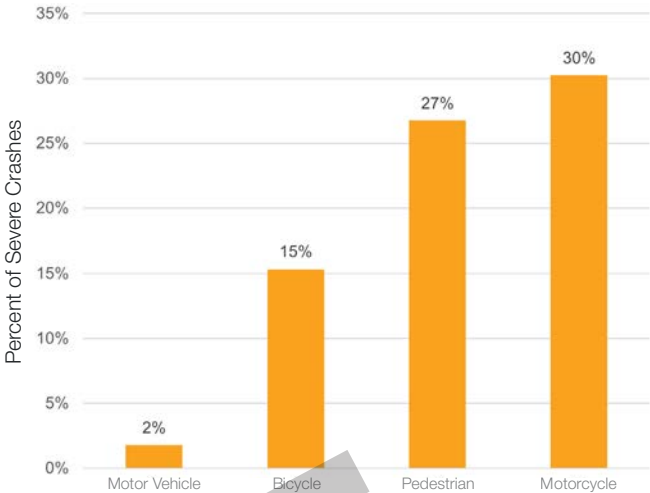
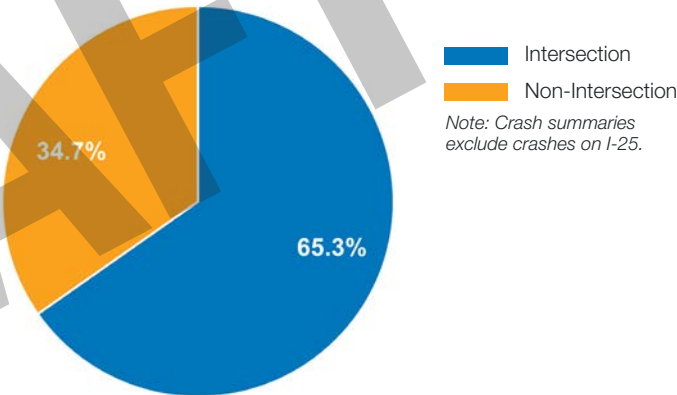


FIGURE 3.7 Percentage of Severe Pedestrian and Bicycle Crashes by Location (2017-2023)
Note: Crash summaries exclude crashes on I-25.



Based on crash data, severe pedestrian and bicycle crashes are more likely to occur on minor arterials than other road types. This is likely due to the higher travel speeds present on arterial roadways and the proximity of minor arterials to residential and local developments.

Severe pedestrian and bicycle crashes are more common in dark conditions as compared to severe motor vehicle crashes. Over 50% of severe pedestrian and bicycle crashes occur when it is dark, dawn, or dusk. This same figure is 39% for severe motor vehicle crashes.

Speed and crash severity are directly related when it comes to pedestrian crashes, as shown in **Figure 3.8**. National data show that when a pedestrian is struck by a motor vehicle, the probability that the person is killed or seriously injured increases with speed.

FIGURE 3.8 Likelihood of Pedestrian Severe or Fatal Injury by Speed

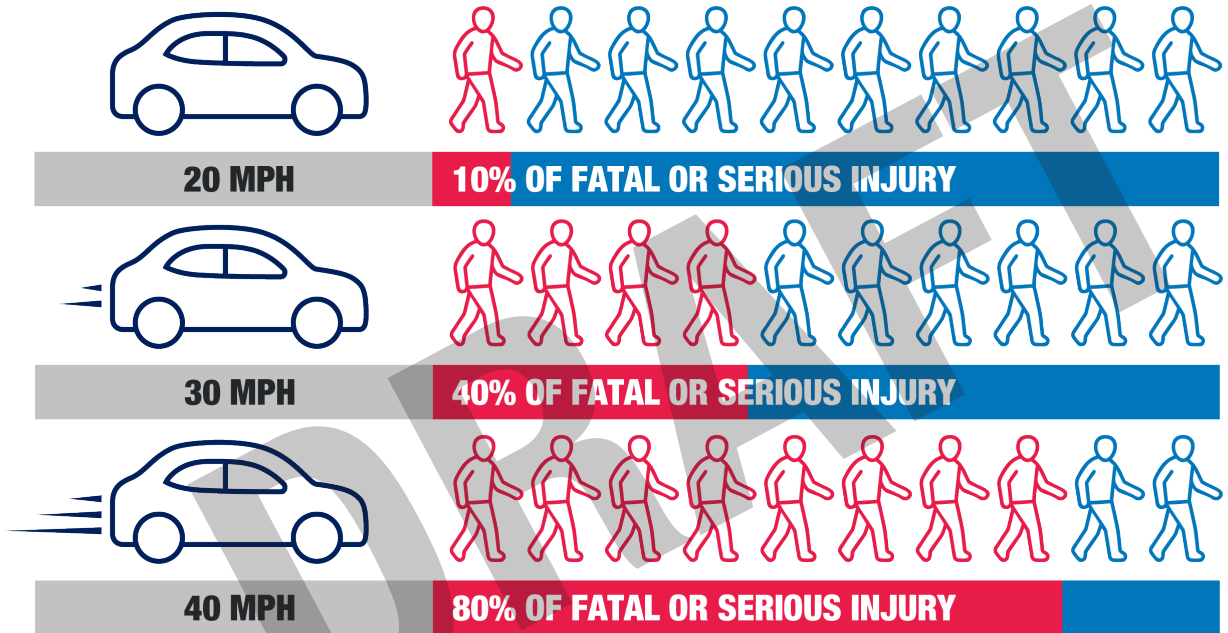
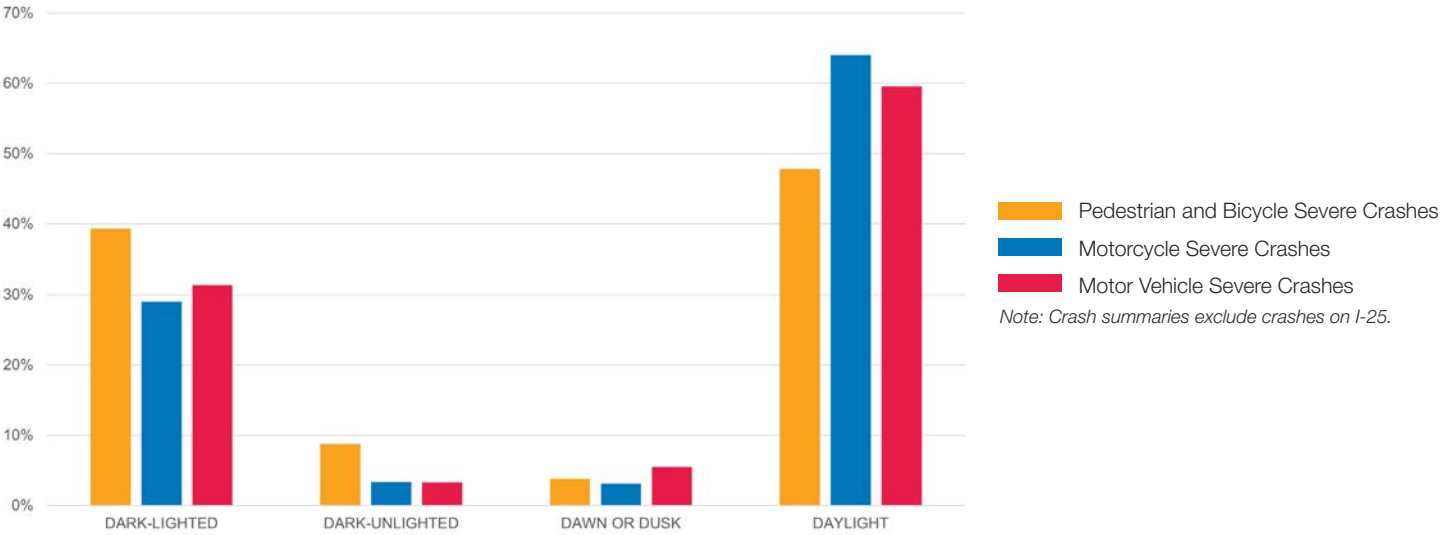


FIGURE 3.9 Proportion of Severe Crashes by Lighting Condition (2017-2023)
Note: Crash summaries exclude crashes on I-25.



Motorcycle Crashes

Motorcycles crashes are significantly overrepresented in severe crashes. From 2017 to 2023, over 30% of motorcycle crashes resulted in severe injury or fatalities as compared to 3% of all traffic crashes being severe. The number of annual severe crashes involving motorcycles has been increasing over time.

When a crash involves a motorcycle, it is 11 times more likely to result in a serious injury or fatality than other motor vehicle crashes. Data indicate that motorcycle crashes are more likely to occur away from intersections, likely due to maneuvers like lane filtering, lane splitting, and overtaking. This indicates severe motorcycle crashes are often a result of risky driver behavior.

From the available data on all severe motorcycle crashes within city limits, 28% involved a rider without a helmet or with an improperly used helmet. Wearing helmets has been proven to reduce motorcycle rider fatalities by up to 42% and brain injuries by up to 69% in motorcycle crashes, highlighting the importance of further community outreach on this issue¹. Additionally, to enhance comprehensive crash reporting, it is important to train those writing crash reports to document helmet usage, so future data accurately demonstrates the safety implications of (in)appropriate helmet use.

WHEN A **MOTORCYCLE CRASH** OCCURS, IT IS **11X MORE LIKELY** TO RESULT IN A **SERIOUS INJURY OR FATALITY** THAN OTHER MOTOR VEHICLE CRASHES.



¹ Source: National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) Countermeasures That Work

Geospatial Analysis

Geospatial analysis is a critical component of understanding severe crash occurrences within the transportation system and surrounding land use. By identifying attributes and categories of crashes, and evaluating them based on where they occurred, the City can uncover surrounding environmental and societal factors that contribute to the frequency of these incidents. This approach allows us to pinpoint areas that require urgent intervention and develop targeted strategies to mitigate severe crashes. Data suggest that severe crashes are likely to occur in areas of social vulnerability, along transit routes, on arterials, and near activity centers.

Areas of Social Vulnerability

An effectively planned transportation system ensures accessible and safe infrastructure for all users. Nationwide trends show that severe crashes are disproportionately occurring in underserved communities.² Therefore it is imperative that any analysis aiming to mitigate severe crashes considers the impacts in these areas relative to their respective demographics.

Several methods have been developed to address this need. The Social Vulnerability Index (SVI) was used for this Plan. The Social Vulnerability Index information is adapted from a U.S. Centers For Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) program designed to identify areas to prioritize for response during natural disasters. Subsequent use of SVI has shown strong correlation between social vulnerability and severe crash occurrence, and it is therefore relevant to the task of targeting efforts to improve traffic safety.

The SVI uses sixteen demographic attributes, grouped into four major areas, to identify census tracts that are more vulnerable to disproportionate impacts from external hazards like traffic crashes. Methodology and use of the SVI is explained further in **Appendix B**.

OVERALL VULNERABILITY



SOCIOECONOMIC STATUS



HOUSEHOLD CHARACTERISTICS



RACIAL AND ETHNIC MINORITY STATUS



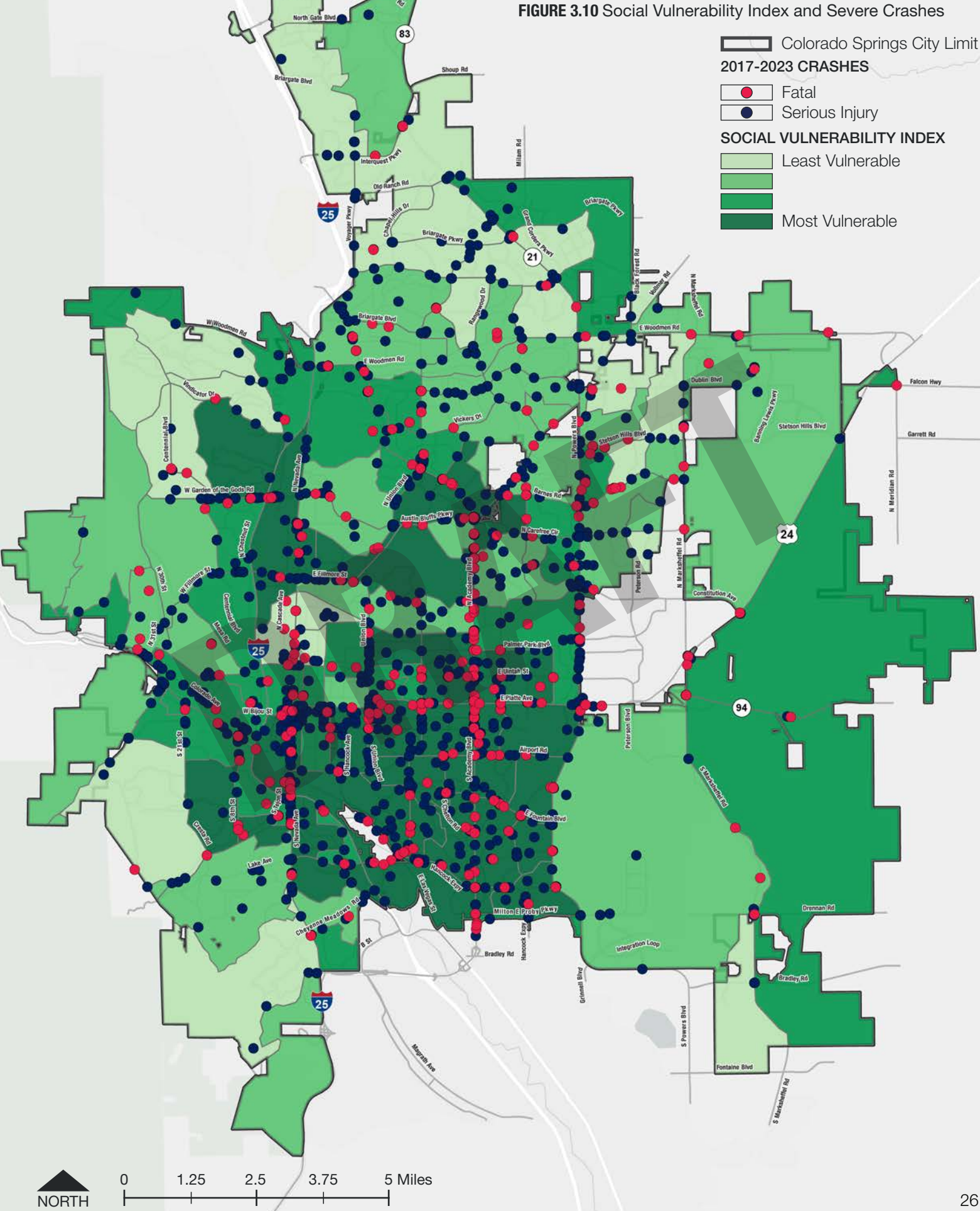
HOUSING TYPE AND TRANSPORTATION

² Defined by the United States Department of Transportation (USDOT) as locations that are located within an Area of Persistent Poverty as defined in the Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act

Table 3.1 depicts how social vulnerability and crash severity are correlated. The index breakdown is defined by the CDC, which was then further expanded upon in the following figures to evaluate the more granular breakdown. Approximately 58% of severe crashes occur in areas with a vulnerability index of 0.75 or greater, which accounts for only 17.3% of area within city limits. Many of the severe crashes on the Colorado Springs network are in the downtown area and the south side of the city, which aligns with known socioeconomic conditions. Over one-fourth of severe crashes within the highly vulnerable areas involve either pedestrians or bicycles.

TABLE 3.1 Social Vulnerability Index and Crash Summary						
Social Vulnerability Index	Definition	Total Crashes	Total Severe Crashes	Area (Square Mile)	Severe Crashes per Centerline Mile	Severe Crashes per Square Mile
0 - 0.25	Low Vulnerability	5,175	148	37.27	0.167	3.89
0.25 - 0.5	Low to Medium Vulnerability	13,918	421	74.71	0.363	5.53
0.5 - 0.75	Medium to High Vulnerability	11,324	344	54.97	0.435	6.15
0.75 - 1	High Vulnerability	22,554	755	35.03	1.03	21.15

Note: Crash summaries exclude crashes on I-25.

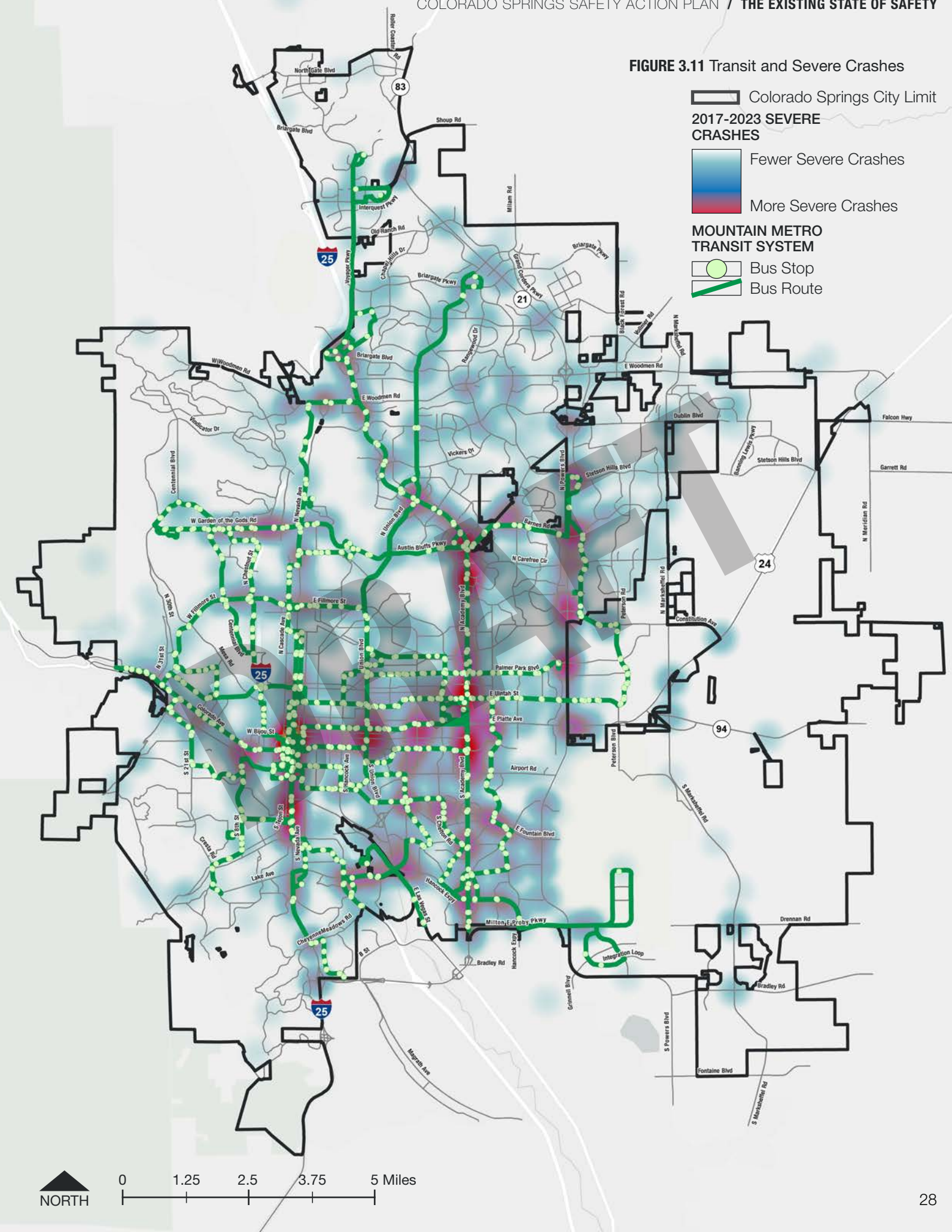


Areas of Transit Stops and Transit Routes

To ensure safe transit access throughout Colorado Springs, crashes occurring within a one-minute walking distance from transit stops were geographically analyzed for noticeable trends. Approximately 17% of all severe crashes occurred within a one-minute walking radius (approximately 200 feet) of a transit stop. Of 298 severe crashes within a minute walking radius, over 25% involved pedestrians and bicycles. This is disproportionate compared to all pedestrian and bicycle crashes, which only accounted for approximately 5% of total crashes citywide. There are many opportunities for conflicts between pedestrians and bicycles and motor vehicle traffic at transit stops, as many transit users must bridge their first and last mile of travel by walking, bicycling, or by using other micromobility solutions. During this modal transition, transit users are at higher risk for crashes, especially severe ones. Based on crash patterns, safety improvements should be prioritized at these locations. Physical barriers or separation and other traffic control and conspicuity design elements at transit stops can help protect pedestrians and bicycles, making the modal transition safer.



FIGURE 3.11 Transit and Severe Crashes



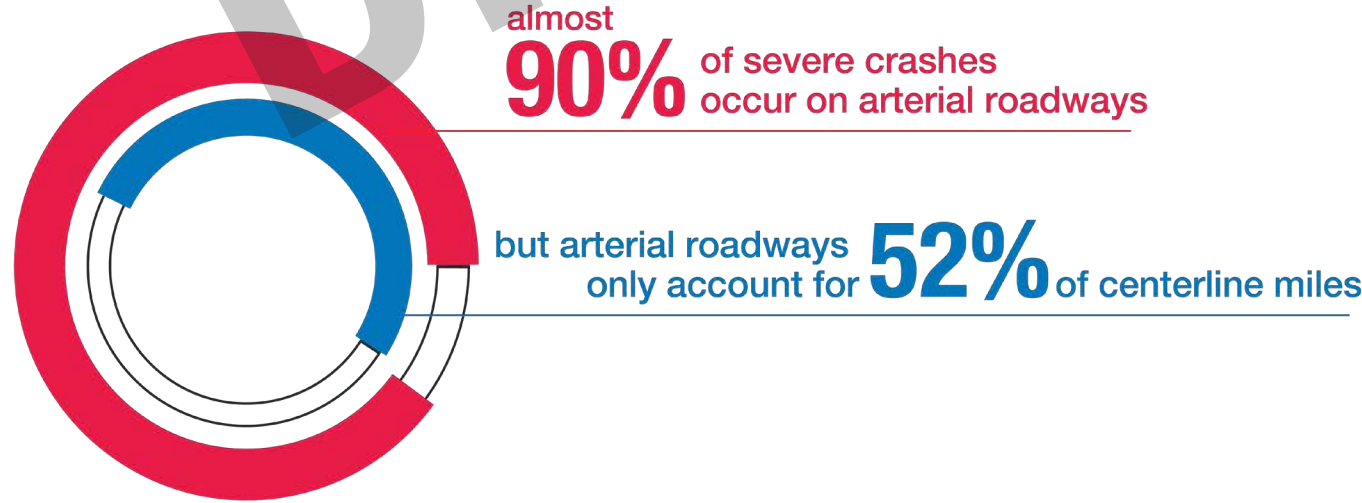
Arterial Roadways

Arterial roadways, or the primary roadways within the city designed to serve longer motor vehicle trips, pose unique safety challenges. These streets often act both as a destination and a thoroughfare, resulting in high roadway speeds while also presenting conflicts among turning movements and multiple modes of travel. This can cause an exponential increase in crash severity. Typically, more activity and conflicts between road users occur along roadways with travel in the 35 – 40 mph range. As confirmed in the Colorado Springs Citywide Safety Study, arterial roadways exhibit the highest crash frequency and severity when compared to other roadway classifications.

Almost 90% of severe crashes within the City of Colorado Springs occur at or along principal or minor arterials. The Colorado Springs Citywide Safety Study analyzed crashes along Colorado Springs’ arterial system. The study then identified the arterial network with Fatal and Injury LOSS of 3 or 4 as the high risk network due to the typical roadway configuration, speeds, frequent intersection spacings, and location as it relates to land use.

FIGURE 3.12 Arterial Roadway Severe Crashes by Centerline Miles

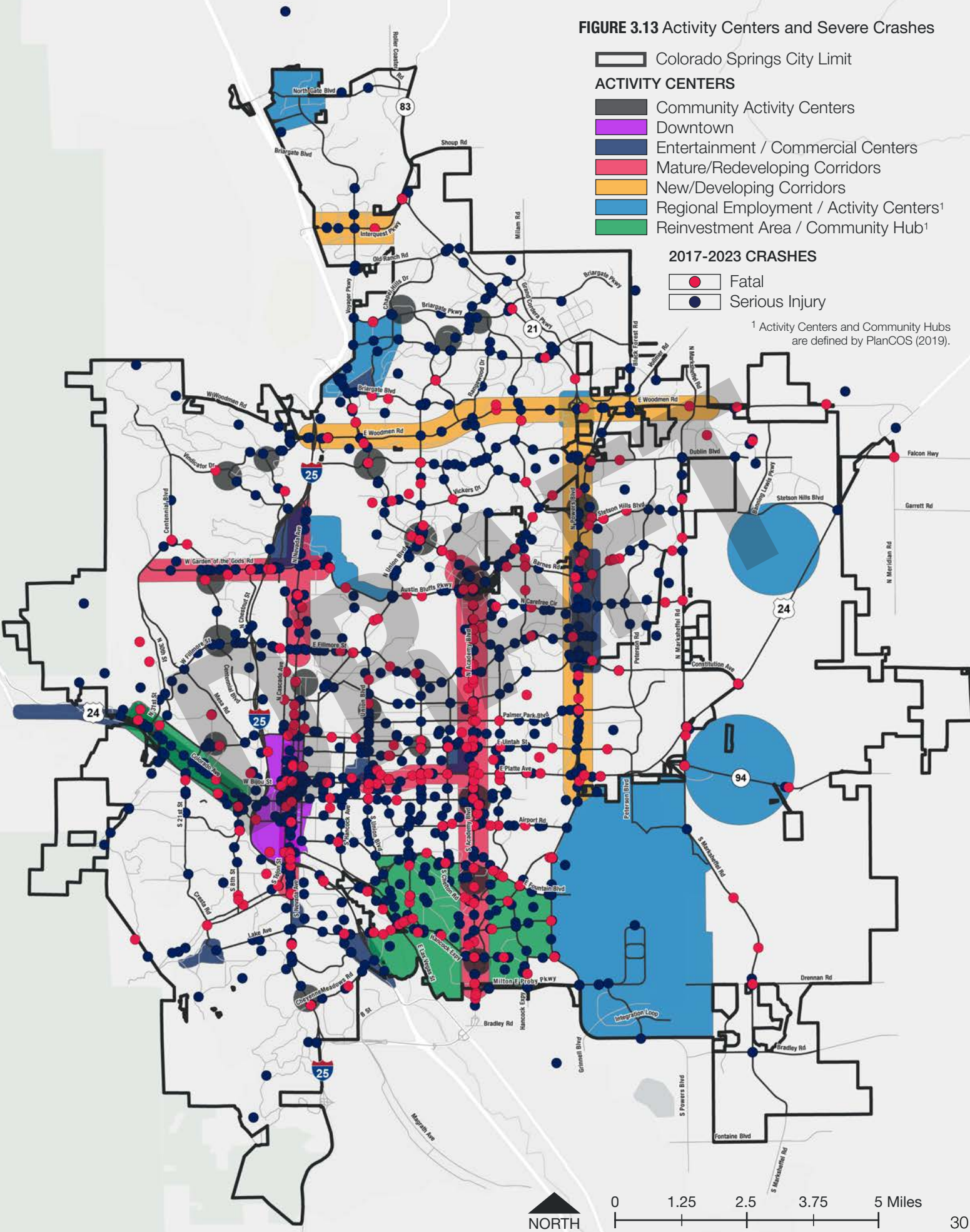
Note: Crash summaries exclude crashes on I-25.



Activity Centers

Areas in and near activity centers were evaluated for crash risk. Downtown Colorado Springs has a crash density of nearly 15 crashes per square mile for collisions involving pedestrians and bicycles. (Of course, Downtown experiences some of the highest levels of pedestrian and bicyclist activity in the city.) In fact, more than a quarter of severe crashes in the downtown area were related to pedestrians or bicycles (99 crashes), which exceeds the downtown area’s number of approach turn and broadside crashes—the crash types most represented citywide. The disproportional number of fatal and serious injury crashes for pedestrians and bicycles in the central business district highlights the need for safety prioritization projects in this area. While the Downtown area comprises only 3% of the city’s land use typologies as defined in PlanCOS (2019), it accounts for 24% of all pedestrian and bicycle crashes.

FIGURE 3.13 Activity Centers and Severe Crashes





High Risk Network

Using crash trends and characteristics, a systemic safety analysis was used to evaluate potential risk across the City's roadway system. This approach identifies patterns that not only look at crash data sources but also pairs contextual factors such as roadway speeds, surrounding area demographics and surrounding land uses. These contextual factors were found to correlate most with the occurrence of severe crashes:

- Corridor Roadway Classification
- Corridor Speeds
- Surrounding Activity Centers / Land Use
- Transit Stops and Transit Routes
- Social Vulnerability Index

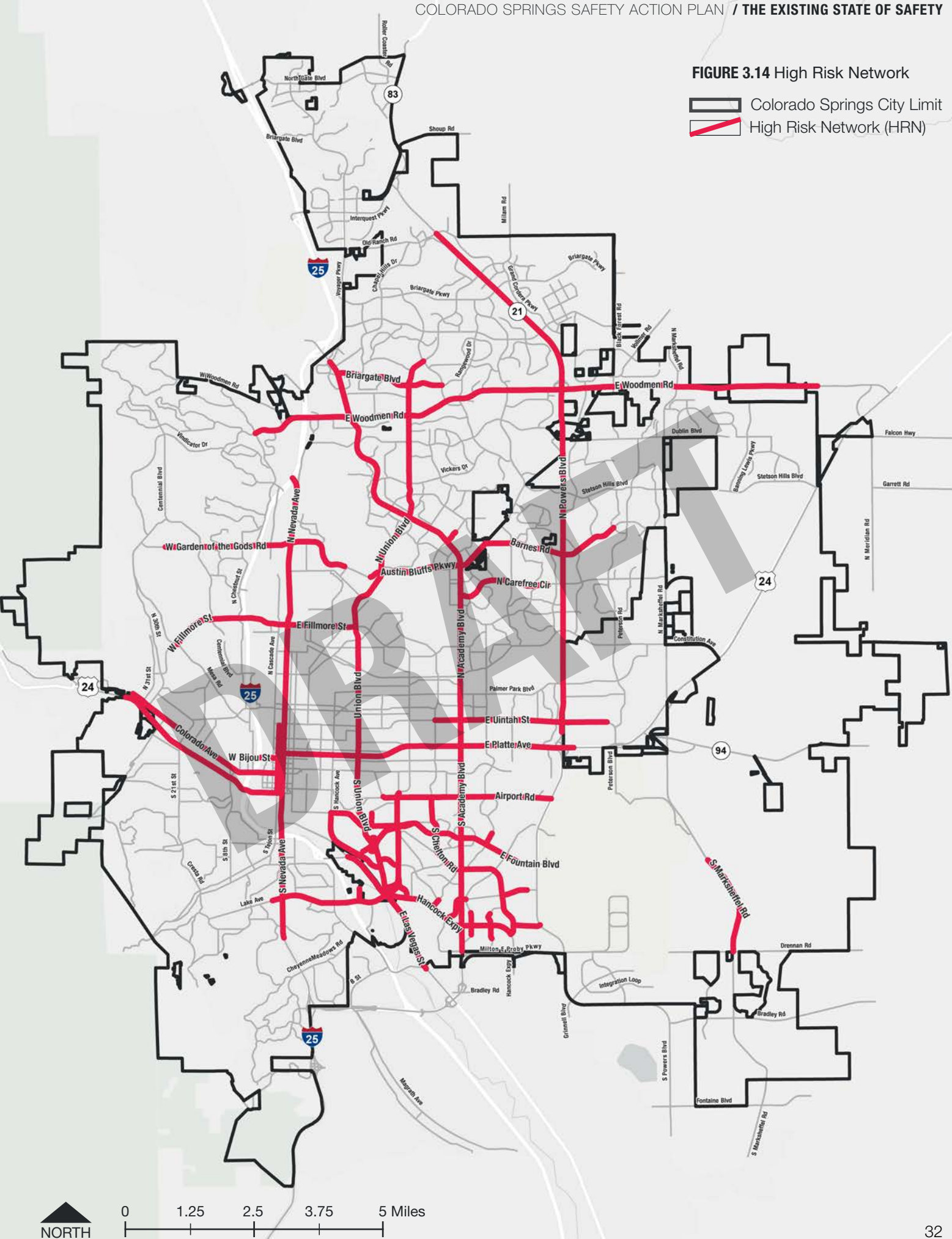
Following the systemic analysis of severe crashes in Colorado Springs, and an assessment of geographical crash trends, a High Risk Network (HRN) was identified within the City's roadway system. The HRN is a mapping tool to help identify not only where traffic crashes have occurred historically but where potential future crashes may occur, based on a high concentration of the contextual factors most associated with severe crashes. The HRN accounts for just 5% (151 centerline miles) of City of Colorado Springs streets (including local and residential streets) but accounts for 53% of all severe crashes within the Colorado Springs network. Beyond the identified HRN, crashes are more dispersed. In addition to accounting for over half of severe crashes on the network, the HRN also accounts for 58% of severe pedestrian crashes, 38% of severe bicycle crashes and 53% of severe motorcycle crashes on Colorado Springs roadways.



FIGURE 3.14 High Risk Network

Colorado Springs City Limit

High Risk Network (HRN)



Many national resources are available that summarize tools for professionals working to improve traffic safety. It can be overwhelming and difficult to fully understand what applies to the specific issues a community is facing. To that end, this Plan includes a toolbox of safety countermeasures that are directly applicable to the challenges of Colorado Springs.

This toolbox was assembled using national best practices and guidelines from publications like Federal Highway Administration’s (FHWA) Proven Safety Countermeasures, the Crash Modification Factor Clearinghouse, and the American Association of State Highway and Transportation Officials (AASHTO) Highway Safety Manual and Guide for the Development of Bicycle Facilities.

The toolbox is divided into two sections: An overview of countermeasures detailed in this chapter, and an easy-to-use reference including applicability and considerations in **Appendix C** intended to be used by technical staff.

Groupings of Countermeasures

Countermeasures can be consolidated by type of application. Typical major groups, such as pedestrian and bicycle improvements or geometric changes (and more), are shown at the end of this chapter. This provides for an introduction to and an overview of the types of applications that might be considered, and highlights the breadth of options. These groupings can be helpful when working within funding constraints such as grants earmarked for specific types of improvements.

THE DESIGN TOOLBOX

Detailed Toolbox Reference - Appendix C

Appendix C is a toolbox intended for technical staff as an easy-to-use reference to narrow down alternatives and to determine the most applicable and appropriate countermeasure for the issue at hand. Note that this toolbox is primarily focused on infrastructure improvements; it is intended to be a quick reference for City staff as they form capital projects, review design plans, or address operational issues. Some of the countermeasures listed involve education, enforcement, programs, or policies that are likely to be applicable for citywide, systemic issues. Toolbox elements are listed in the sections below.

Location and Type of Crash

The most important consideration for identifying countermeasures is to fully understand the issue, contributing factors, and context. This involves determining both the location of the issue and the types of crashes that are occurring in order to identify appropriate actions. For instance, countermeasures implemented at intersections address different concerns than countermeasures implemented along roadway segments. The toolbox in **Appendix C** is organized by location and crash type for easy use.

Implementation Categories

Addressing an issue can be done in various ways. For some issues a minor effort involving signing and striping is adequate. For others, a larger geometric or capital project may be needed, or the issue may be more citywide, and a systematic approach or revised policy would be appropriate. Separating out countermeasures into various implementation categories can help target solutions that meet the available time frame, budget, or staff bandwidth.

Applicability, Considerations, and Cautions

The final few columns in the toolbox highlight additional information for the technical staff to be fully informed and understand advantages and disadvantages of each option. This is where context can be important, and information can help narrow down options to those that are the most appropriate and effective.

How to Use the Toolbox Reference

- The following steps should be followed to use the toolbox and identify appropriate treatments:
- Use data and crash analysis to identify issues and trends to be addressed.
 - Complete a detailed review of the crash data to fully understand contributing factors and underlying causes. This may involve reading individual crash reports.
 - Use the toolbox in **Appendix C** to find candidate countermeasures based on location and type of crash.
 - Review implementation categories to narrow choices for those that align with budget, funding, time and staff availability.
 - Check applicability and considerations/cautions. Various countermeasures for similar issues can vary in effectiveness and cost, and toolbox users should carefully review these elements to be fully informed and understand advantages and disadvantages of each option.

Groupings of Countermeasures

The detailed toolbox intended for technical staff use is included in **Appendix C**. The groupings below provide a high-level overview of options.

TABLE 4.1 Pedestrian and Bicycle Improvement Countermeasures			
COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Protected or buffered bicycle lanes	Safe Roads A physical space in the road that separates bicycle lanes from travel lanes, protected lanes typically involve some type of vertical element.	\$\$	
Bicycle signal heads at intersections	Safe Roads Bicycle signal heads are a traffic control device at a signalized intersection providing guidance and right of way control specifically for bicyclists.	\$\$\$	
Dedicated, signalized pedestrian or bicycle crossings	Safe Roads These traffic control devices are designed to provide specific time for pedestrians or bicyclists to cross a roadway that is separated in time from motor vehicle movements.	\$\$\$	
Marking or signing visibility enhancements	Safe Roads These signs, markings or devices are designed to maximize their noticability, recognition and compliance by drivers and pedestrians.	\$	
\$ \$\$ \$\$\$ \$\$\$\$ \$\$\$\$\$ ←Least ExpensiveMost Expensive→			

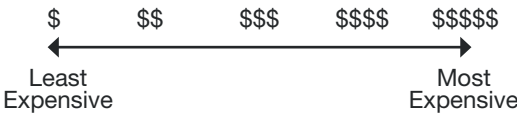


TABLE 4.1 Pedestrian and Bicycle Improvement Countermeasures (Continued)

COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Added sidewalk	Safe Roads A range of upgrades can be made to sidewalks, from basic repairs to new installations, full replacement, or relocation.	\$\$\$\$\$	
Sidewalk repairs or maintenance		\$\$\$	
Relocated pedestrian pushbuttons (at traffic signals)	Safe Roads Current national standards require pedestrian push buttons to be accessible. This often requires relocating push buttons onto their own pole close to the curb ramp.	\$\$\$	
Pedestrian refuge islands	Safe Roads A range of upgrades can be made to roadway crossings.	\$\$	
Curb extension/bump outs		\$\$	
Raised crosswalks		\$\$\$	
Pedestrian activated signals		\$\$\$\$\$	
Rectangular Rapid Flashing Beacons		\$	

TABLE 4.2 Geometric Changes Countermeasures

COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Added curbs	Safe Roads The addition of curb defines the roadway edge and separates the roadway from other areas such as sidewalk, parking spaces or landscaping.	\$\$	
Added right or left turn lanes	Safe Roads The addition of turn lanes can significantly improve safety and traffic flow at intersections providing space for decelerating and stopped motor vehicles.	\$\$\$	
Access management	Safe Roads Access management involves a set of strategies and techniques used to control how motor vehicles access public roadways, aiming to improve safety and traffic flow and reduce congestion.	\$\$\$\$\$	
Grade separation	Safe Roads Roadways can be constructed at different elevations to eliminate at-grade intersections with numerous conflict points.	\$\$\$\$\$	

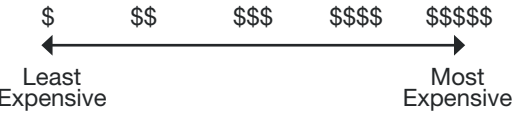


TABLE 4.2 Geometric Changes Countermeasures (Continued)

COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Sight distance improvements	Safe Roads Increasing visibility along roadways to support safety can involve addressing obstructions, road geometry, landscaping and more.	\$\$	
Roundabout construction	Safe Roads Roundabouts can improve safety by reducing the number of conflicts points and supporting lower travel speeds in intersections.	\$\$\$\$\$	
Protected intersection construction	Safe Roads A protected intersection is a type of at-grade intersection in which bicyclists and pedestrians are separated from vehicles in both time and/or location.	\$\$\$\$	
Shoulder widening	Safe Roads Increasing the width of the area of the road outside of the travel lanes can accommodate bicycles, provide a recovery zone, and allow vehicles a place to stop safely if needed.	\$\$\$	
Neighborhood traffic calming (speed humps, chicanes, etc.)	Safe Roads Neighborhood traffic calming involves strategies and small geometric changes to slow vehicles on residential and collector streets within residential areas.	\$\$\$	

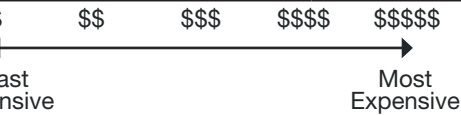


TABLE 4.3 Marking and Signing Countermeasures

COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Advanced warning signs or markings	Safe Roads Advanced warning signs alert drivers to upcoming conditions or situations, providing time to react.	\$	
Lane reconfiguration	Safe Roads This engineering strategy reconfigures a road by reducing the number of vehicle travel lanes, often from four to three, to provide for turn lanes, bicycle lanes, or on-street parking.	\$\$	
Added edge lines	Safe Roads Add edge lines to clearly demarcate pavement edge.	\$	
Widened edge lines	Safe Roads Municipalities have started striping edge lines with six-inch (instead of four-inch) lines for added visibility.	\$	
Added stop or yield lines	Safe Roads Stop and yield line markings supplement signs and guide road users at intersections.	\$	
Curve delineation	Safe Roads Treatments along roadway curves (e.g., warning signs or chevrons) alert drivers to curves, including information about direction of curve, sharpness, and appropriate speed.	\$	
Parking prohibition near intersections	Safe Roads Prohibiting parking near intersections can enhance visibility for drivers as they enter a roadway and allow better sight distance and visibility for pedestrians and bicyclists.	\$	

TABLE 4.4 Traffic Signals Countermeasures			
COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Added or adjusted signal heads	Safe Roads Adding or adjusting traffic signal heads typically involves ensuring that they are positioned for optimal visibility and compliance.	\$	
Retroreflective backplates	Safe Roads The addition of retroreflective backplates for signal heads enhances visibility, particularly in challenging conditions such as strong sunlight, fog, or power outages.	\$	
Modified left-turn phase	Safe Roads Changing left turn phasing from protected/permited or permitted to protected-only phasing provides for a dedicated time in a traffic signal cycle for left turns that is not in conflict with any other movements, including pedestrians.	\$	
Adjusted pedestrian or bicycle signal phases	Safe Roads Adjusting pedestrian or bicycle signal phases provides these users with greater visibility and fewer conflicts. This can include Leading Pedestrian Intervals that give a pedestrian a head start at the beginning of a phase before vehicles get a green light.	\$	

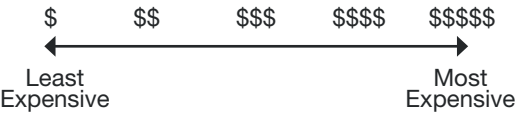


TABLE 4.4 Traffic Signals Countermeasures (Continued)			
COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Automated enforcement	Safe Speeds Automated enforcement utilizes technology like speed safety cameras and red light cameras to detect and ticket traffic violations.	\$\$	
Yellow or red clearance interval adjustments	Safe Roads Clearance intervals are designed to provide a transition between conflicting movements. Calculations should incorporate current best practices taking speed and intersection size into consideration.	\$	
Unwarranted traffic signal removal	Safe Roads Unwarranted signals were installed without meeting the established warrants and may be more of a safety risk than a benefit. Removal of unwarranted signals can improve safety.	\$\$	
Corridor retiming	Safe Roads Corridors with closely spaced signals can benefit from being carefully timed to progress traffic and reduce the number of vehicles arriving at an intersection on red.	\$	

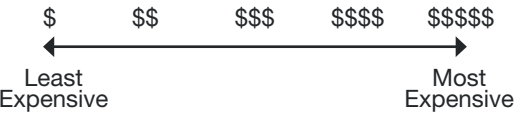
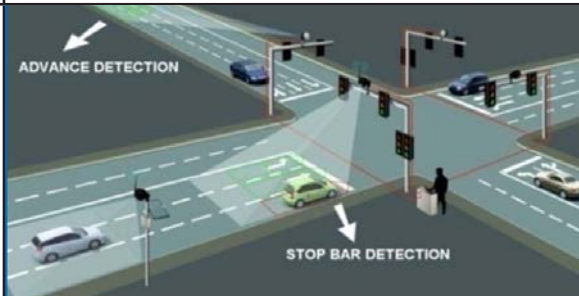


TABLE 4.4 Traffic Signals Countermeasures (Continued)

COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Advanced detection	Safe Roads Advanced detection tracks vehicle speeds and distance to reduce vehicles caught in the dilemma zone and to reduce stops.	\$	 The diagram illustrates a vehicle approaching an intersection. A green cone labeled 'ADVANCE DETECTION' extends from the vehicle, and a white cone labeled 'STOP BAR DETECTION' extends from the stop bar. The vehicle is shown in the 'dilemma zone' between the two detection zones.
Emergency preemption	Safe Roads Preempting signals for emergency vehicles improves response times and can reduce secondary crashes.	\$\$	 The image shows a red fire truck with emergency lights flashing, approaching an intersection. The truck is marked with the number '2' and the word 'Springfield'.

A number line diagram illustrating the relationship between the number of dollar signs and the cost of a product. The line has five tick marks labeled \$, \$\$, \$\$\$, \$\$\$\$, and \$\$\$\$\$. Below the line, an arrow points from left to right, with "Least Expensive" at the left end and "Most Expensive" at the right end. A grey shaded area is under the right end of the line.

TABLE 4.5 Other Countermeasures

COUNTERMEASURE	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT AND DESCRIPTION	COST	REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE
Street lighting	Safe Roads Street lighting enhances safety and security and improves visibility for, and of, all road users.	\$\$\$	
Study: crash hazards or patterns for motorcycle crashes	Safe Roads Targeted safety analyses could help understand the causes of motorcycle crashes.	\$	
Study: speed limit setting	Safe Speeds A comprehensive, consistent policy using current national best practices for setting speeds limits can provide clarity, consistency, and enhanced safety.	\$	
Education campaigns	Safe Speeds Education campaigns can target specific groups of people, or increase general awareness and safety.	\$\$	
Targeted enforcement	Safe Speeds Law enforcement and Public Works should collaborate to develop a data-driven program aimed at identifying and enforcing areas most prone to speeding.	\$	
Dynamic speed display signs	Safe Roads Electronic signs displaying vehicle speeds remind drivers of posted speed limit.	\$	

SAFETY STRATEGIES FOR COS

Safety Values for Colorado Springs

The values shown in the graphic below shaped the strategies and actions in this Plan along with input from City staff and key stakeholders. As this Plan is implemented, future initiatives and efforts should be compared against these values to ensure they align with the community's vision for a safe and inclusive transportation network.

FIGURE 5.1 Safety Values



A Network for All

Every person – regardless of travel mode – deserves to be safe while using our transportation network. This Plan envisions a transportation system that protects and respects all users, including pedestrians, bicyclists, motorcyclists, drivers, and transit users. Whether users are a resident, military personnel, or visitor, this Plan helps ensure travel on Colorado Springs streets is as safe as possible.

Data-Driven Decisions

Our evidence-based solutions are grounded in industry best practices and tailored to address local transportation safety concerns. By leveraging previous citywide safety analysis, systemic crash data analysis, and proven safety countermeasures, this Plan provides strategies and actions that address Colorado Springs transportation challenges.

Culture of Safety

Safety is a shared community value. This Plan promotes a culture of awareness, responsibility, and education, ensuring everyone plays a role in creating a safer transportation network for our community.

Partnerships and Collaborations

Improving safety is a collective effort. This Plan strengthens existing partnerships and seeks to foster new collaboration across agencies, organizations, and community groups to achieve our shared vision. The Plan also strives to foster partnerships with military installations, understanding that their residents are an integral and influential part the Colorado Springs community.

Transparent Progress and Accountability

Our progress is measurable and openly shared. Project progress and outcomes are shared with the rest of the community to build trust and to ensure accountability from our leaders.

THE ACTION PLAN

The Action Plan Framework

This chapter presents the framework for the Safety Action Plan and its recommendations. The framework elements include programs, policies, partnerships, and projects, all of which are defined on the following page.

Each category (i.e., program, policy, or partnership) within this chapter is organized by how individual strategies address the tenets of the Safe System Approach. This approach ensures that the strategies are comprehensive and cover the City's needs via programs, policies, and relevant partnerships. Projects are included and are described following **Table 6.1**.

Key Safety Objectives

- Develop prioritized list of synthesized projects from other safety planning efforts.
- Reduce motorcycle fatal and serious injury crashes.
- Establish a safety focused approach to infrastructure improvements and prioritization thereof.
- Build on existing partnerships with organizations like Colorado Department of Public Health and Environment, Colorado Springs Police Department, Colorado Springs Fire Department, Colorado Department of Transportation, and military base leadership.

The Action Plan Elements

Policy changes, partnerships and collaborations, programs, and projects are the elements of the action plan. The action items are not shown in any particular order. Again, projects are included and are described following **Table 6.1**.

Policy Changes

Policies are formal rules, regulations, or guiding principles adopted by an organization or government to influence decisions and achieve rational outcomes. Their role in safety action planning includes:

- Setting the framework and expectations for safety.
- Establishing and revising existing standards and policies.
- Guiding decision-making and resource allocation.
- Often becoming codified in plans, ordinances, or resolutions.

Partnerships and Collaborations

Partnerships are collaborative relationships between agencies, organizations, or stakeholders to support and enhance safety efforts. Their role in safety action planning includes:

- Enabling resource sharing, data exchange, and joint initiatives.
- Fostering community engagement and interagency coordination.
- Addressing cross-jurisdictional or systemic safety issues.

Programs

Programs are organized efforts or initiatives designed to implement policies and achieve specific safety outcomes. Their role in safety action planning includes:

- Translating policies into actionable steps.
- Funding, staffing, and performance metrics.
- Pilot projects, education campaigns, or engineering interventions.

Safety Progress is Underway

In addition to the strategies in **Table 6.1**, the City is already undertaking these actions:

- Defining uses and scenarios for enhanced pedestrian crossings with better visibility and lighting to prevent crashes.
- Administering a Neighborhood Traffic Calming Program that creates easy to implement solutions allowing the City to rapidly adjust and change neighborhood streets using speed humps, curb extensions, and traffic circles.
- Implementing policies and safety features for school zones, trail crossings, left turn phasing at traffic signals, lane reallocations, and traffic calming.

As an example of current safety improvement efforts, the City is currently using funds from the Federal Highway Safety Improvement Program (HSIP) to implement safety improvements at the following signalized intersections:

- Garden of the Gods Road and Mark Dabling Boulevard
- Garden of the Gods Road and Northpark Drive
- Academy Boulevard and Galley Road
- Murray Boulevard and Palmer Park Boulevard
- Academy Boulevard and Shrider Road
- Rangewood Drive and Woodemen Road
- Barnes Road and Oro Blanco Drive
- Hancock Expressway and Jet Wing Drive



TABLE 6.1 Action Items

ACTION TYPE	ACTION ITEM	RESPONSIBLE PARTY	SUPPORTING PARTIES	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT	TIMELINE
Policy Change	1 Launch educational campaigns on the importance of seatbelt use and safe driving practices.	• El Paso County Public Health (EPCPH) • City Communications	• Drive Smart • CDOT • Colorado Springs Police Department (CSPD) • School Districts • Common Spirit Health - Trauma CSFD • Fitness to Drive	Safer People	Short-term
Policy Change	2 Update City design criteria and documents to reflect a policy to prioritize safety in all street design projects.	• Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	• Colorado Springs Planning Department • Accessibility the Independence Center • COS Walk the Walk	Safer Roads	Immediate
Policy Change	3 Develop robust guidelines for traffic impact studies completed for private development that integrate street design, traffic safety, and the City's transportation network vision.	• Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	• Colorado Springs Planning Department • City Council • Mayor's Office • CDOT • Mountain Metro Transit (MMT)	Safer Roads	Immediate
Policy Change	4 Introduce additional design standards for safe infrastructure. All toolbox countermeasures, such as protected bicycle lanes, pedestrian refuge islands, high-visibility crosswalks, and others should have a standard design template created to reduce cost and speed of implementation.	• Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	• Colorado Springs Public Works (Engineering Division) • CSFD • COS Walk the Walk • Accessibility the Independence Center • MMT	Safer Roads	Long-term
Policy Change	5 Introduce variable speed limits based on traffic conditions and weather to optimize safety.	• Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	• CDOT • Mayor's Office	Safer Speeds	Long-term
Policy Change	6 Work with Colorado Springs Police Department to introduce highly visible enforcement, starting at targeted high-crash corridors.	• CSPD	• CDOT • Mayor's Office	Safer Speeds	Immediate
Policy Change	7 Pursue the latest safety features in all City fleet motor vehicles. These features could include hands-free, inside/outside cameras, telematics, collision avoidance systems, etc.	• Colorado Springs Facilities	• Colorado Springs Risk Management • City Council • Colorado Springs Fleet Manager • MMT	Safer Vehicles	Long-term
Policy Change	8 Ensure rapid response times for emergency services through better coordination and resource allocation.	• CSPD • Colorado Springs Fire Department (CSFD)	• Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division) • Emergency Medical Services • 911 Authority • Mayor's Office • Common Spirit Health EMS Institute • Public Health - Maternal and Child Health (MCH)	Post-Crash Care	Long-term

TABLE 6.1 Action Items (Continued)

ACTION TYPE	ACTION ITEM	RESPONSIBLE PARTY	SUPPORTING PARTIES	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT	TIMELINE
Policy Change	9 Provide comprehensive training for first responders on handling traffic crash victims.	• CSFD • Common Spirit Health	• Medical Community • Emergency Medical Services • Hospitals • CSPD • Disability Education The Independence Center • Public Health - MCH (Child and Youth with Special Health Care Needs [CYSHCN] Response Education)	Post-Crash Care	Short-term
Partnerships and Collaboration	10 Build on the Drive Smart Colorado program. • Partner with local schools to develop educational programs that emphasize the importance of road safety and the use of seatbelts. • Expand and formalize the role of the program, bringing public works, police, public health, community organizations, and others into the decision-making process.	• Drive Smart • Choose SAFE (Common Spirit)	• PPACG • School districts • Public Health	Safer People	Immediate
Partnerships and Collaboration	11 Create Data Sharing Partnership agreements with entities such as hospitals, emergency responders, and universities, to better understand crash causes and outcomes.	• EPCPH	• Injury Prevention Manager(s) (Community Spirit/UC Health) • Public Health Planner • PPACG • Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division) • MMT	Safer People	Immediate
Partnerships and Collaboration	12 Weekend Rider Safety Initiative: Deploy targeted enforcement, mobile safety checkpoints, and public awareness campaigns on popular weekend motorcycle routes. Partner with local cafes or gas stations for “Ride Smart” pop-ups offering free safety checks and gear giveaways. • Why: 45% of fatal motorcycle crashes in Colorado Springs occur on weekends (Friday-Sunday).	• Drive Smart	• MMT • CSPD • CO Motorcycle Operator Safety Training	Safer People <i>Motorcycle Specific</i>	Short-term
Partnerships and Collaboration	13 Group Riding Education: Partner with motorcycle clubs, Motorcycle Safety Foundation instructors, and local dealerships to offer voluntary group riding workshops with certification for safe formation, communication, and pacing. • Why: Group riding contributes to crash severity due to peer pressure and poor communication.	• Motorcycle Safety Foundation / CO MOST	• Ride Coaches / Trainers • Common Spirit Trauma	Safer People <i>Motorcycle Specific</i>	Long-term
Partnerships and Collaboration	14 Form advisory groups between City departments and local representatives when evaluating and designing intersections and roadways to improve overall road infrastructure.	• Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	• Project-specific Advisory Groups	Safer Roads	Long-term
Partnerships and Collaboration	15 Partner with community organizations to raise awareness about the dangers of speeding, particularly in residential areas, work zones, and near schools.	• CSPD	• Drive Smart • Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division) • EPCPH • School Districts • COS Walk the Walk • Choose Safe Common Spirit • The Independence Center • City Communications	Safer Speeds	Immediate

TABLE 6.1 Action Items (Continued)

ACTION TYPE	ACTION ITEM	RESPONSIBLE PARTY	SUPPORTING PARTIES	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT	TIMELINE
Partnerships and Collaboration	16 Train police on completing crash reports, including data sharing on the involvement of CYSHCN.	CSPD	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	Post-Crash Care	Short-term
Partnerships and Collaboration	17 Team with hospitals to ensure that emergency services are well-equipped and trained to handle traffic crash victims.	Colorado State Health Department	- Regional Emergency Trauma Advisory Council (RETAC) - Emergency Medical Services - Public Health - MCH - Common Spirit - School Districts - El Paso County Traffic Engineering - PPACG - City Council - Bike COS	Post-Crash Care	Long-term
Programs	18 Continue funding for the City's school safety program, which provides funding for crossing guards, school flasher installation, small infrastructure changes, and signal and flasher maintenance.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	- Salvation Army Family Hope Center/Mckinney-Vents - COS Walk the Walk	Safer People	Immediate
Programs	19 Increase support for expanded local public transit service and access.	MMT	- Mayor's Office - City Council - Congressional Representatives	Safer People	Short-term
Programs	20 Create a Road Safety Audit Program to conduct proactive safety audits to identify and mitigate risks before crashes occur.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	- CSPD - CO MOST/Ride Coaches/Trainers - COS Walk the Walk - Pike Ride	Safer Roads	Long-term
Programs	21 Motorcycle Curve Safety Program: Identify high-risk curves and implement additional curve signing and delineation, high-friction surface treatments, and modify current guardrail specifications to be motorcycle-friendly.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	- CSPD - CO MOST and Ride Coaches/Trainers	Safer Roads <i>Motorcycle Specific</i>	Short-term
Programs	22 Develop dedicated lanes and crossings for pedestrians and bicyclists to reduce conflicts with motor vehicles.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	- El Paso County Traffic Engineering - CSPD - COS Walk the Walk - Pike Ride - The Independence Center - Bike COS - City Council	Safer Roads	Long-term
Programs	23 Intersection Visibility and Filtering Policy: Consider advancing the stop lines at intersections, bringing vehicles further into the line of sight for crossing traffic, and daylight intersections from parked cars, vegetation, and other visual impediments while keeping slow-encouraging geometrics.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	- Colorado Springs Forestry - COS Walk the Walk	Safer Roads	Short-term

TABLE 6.1 Action Items (Continued)					
ACTION TYPE	ACTION ITEM	RESPONSIBLE PARTY	SUPPORTING PARTIES	SAFE SYSTEM COMPONENT	TIMELINE
Programs	24 Implement crossing improvements and enforce speed limits in areas with high pedestrian traffic or near schools.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	- CSPD - School Districts	Safer Speeds	Long-term
Programs	25 Install speed safety cameras in arterial and collector corridors, starting with high-risk areas, to improve safety through compliance with speed limits.	CSPD	- City Council - Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	Safer Speeds	Long-term
Programs	26 Introduce an Arterial Speed Management Program that includes speed limit reductions, speed feedback signs, and signal timing adjustments.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	CSPD	Safer Speeds	Short-term
Programs	27 Create a Trauma Liaison Response Program (TLRP) that deploys trauma-informed professionals (e.g., trauma nurses, behavioral health clinicians, or trained crisis responders) to support EMS in field triage and stabilization, provide on-site psychological first aid to victims, witnesses, and families, and collect real-time crash data for injury prevention research. - Potential Partners: UCHealth Memorial Hospital Trauma Center, Military Medical professionals as a training program and/or experienced military medical professionals to continue to leverage their skills. - Deployment Criteria: Fatal or serious injury crashes, crashes involving children or multiple victims, high-visibility or traumatic incidents (e.g., school zones, group motorcycle rides).	CSFD	- Emergency Medical Services - Hospitals - Common Spirit Health - EPCPH	Post-Crash Care	Long-term
Programs	28 Install emergency vehicle preemption on all arterial street approaches at traffic signals in the City.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	- CDOT - CSPD - CSFD - Emergency Medical Services	Post-Crash Care	Short-term
Programs	29 Develop a program to make systematic low-cost safety improvements to traffic signals, thereby bringing them up to current City standards. Example treatments are supplemental signal heads and retroreflective backplates.	Colorado Springs Public Works (Traffic Division)	CSPD	Safer Roads	Short-term

Projects

When creating this Plan, the City was able to draw upon other safety planning efforts, specifically the Citywide Safety Study and the Arterial Safety Study, that had been undertaken in the recent past. Both of these studies focused on identifying potential for safety improvements using the Level of Service of Safety methodology. This gives a grade, from I to IV, of each intersection and roadway segment that represents how a facility compares to the statewide average for similar facilities. From this analysis, the studies can pinpoint which intersection or segment has the most potential for safety improvements and the most effective infrastructure changes to apply.

Master lists of these important safety projects were then extracted from the plans and projects for this Plan. The lists were created by consolidating individual projects from the two safety studies with safety-focused projects from ConnectCOS and a master list of other safety-related projects from the City. This resulted in two categories of blended projects, capital and systemic, that are structured to make them both efficient at improving traffic safety and competitive for federal funding.

Capital Projects

Capital projects were assembled from smaller projects within a common area. For example, all safety improvements along the alignment of a certain street with common endpoints would be considered one capital project on the list. Consolidating projects in this way allows the City to address all the identified safety challenges in one project, achieving efficiencies in schedule and cost. Example projects include:

- **Colorado Avenue – 30th Street to I-25:** Install edge line markings, lane reconfiguration, raised medians, alternative analysis and improvements at 21st Street, sidewalk improvements, landscaping, and bicycle and pedestrian crossings.
- **Marksheffel Road – Peterson AFB to Drennan Road:** Install wide edge lines, curve warning signs, median barrier, and edge line or centerline rumble strips.

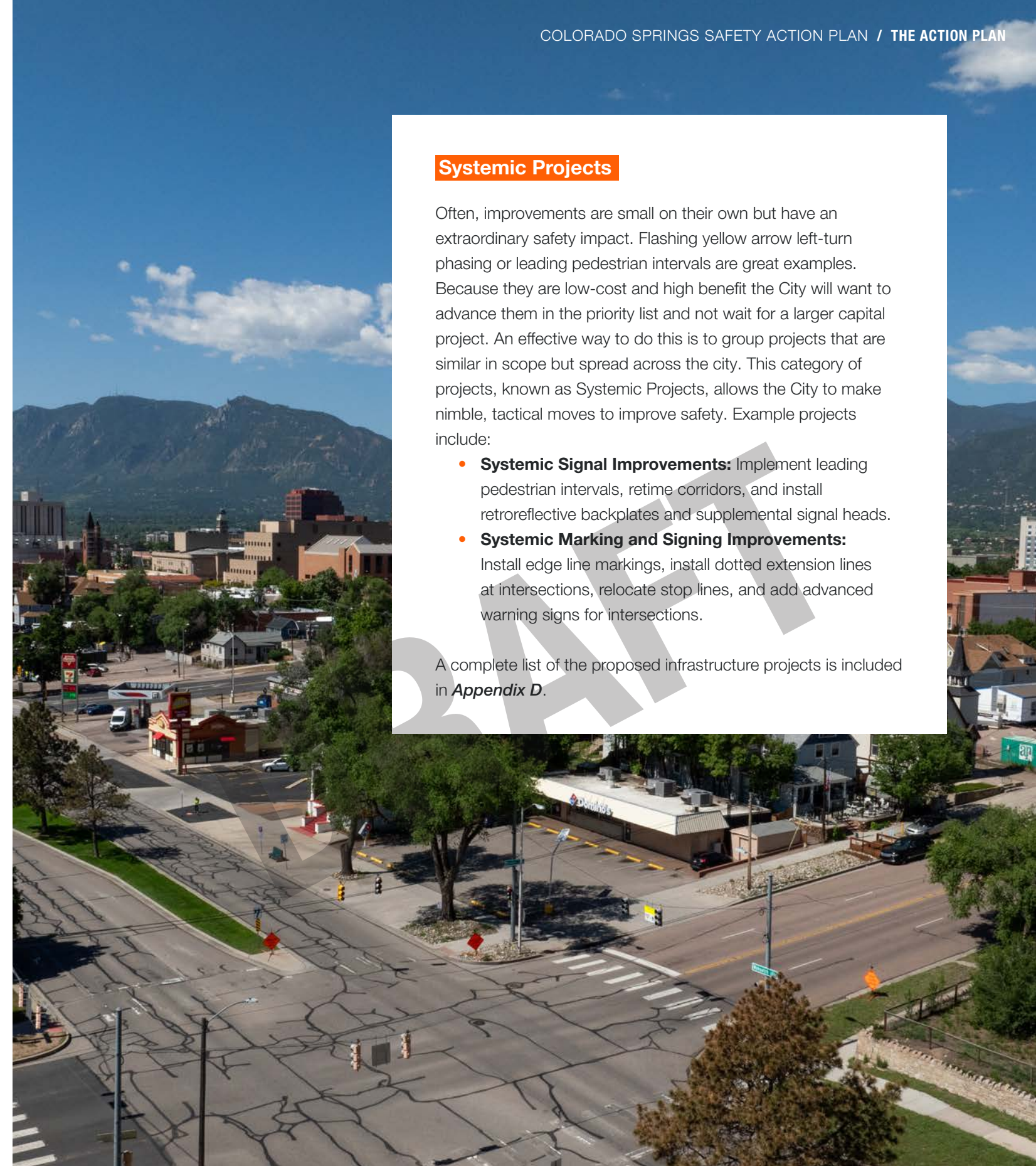


Systemic Projects

Often, improvements are small on their own but have an extraordinary safety impact. Flashing yellow arrow left-turn phasing or leading pedestrian intervals are great examples. Because they are low-cost and high benefit the City will want to advance them in the priority list and not wait for a larger capital project. An effective way to do this is to group projects that are similar in scope but spread across the city. This category of projects, known as Systemic Projects, allows the City to make nimble, tactical moves to improve safety. Example projects include:

- **Systemic Signal Improvements:** Implement leading pedestrian intervals, retime corridors, and install retroreflective backplates and supplemental signal heads.
- **Systemic Marking and Signing Improvements:** Install edge line markings, install dotted extension lines at intersections, relocate stop lines, and add advanced warning signs for intersections.

A complete list of the proposed infrastructure projects is included in **Appendix D**.



The Action Plan's Purpose and Function

Project prioritization involved evaluating locations based on a set of criteria designed to address areas with the most significant risks and potential for impactful improvement. The criteria emphasize locations on key risk networks, input from the community, and alignment with previous plans.

Prioritization Criteria

- **Fatal and Injury LOSS Network:** Segments and intersections on this network of city streets are given priority due to their elevated history of severe crashes. For instance, a corridor with multiple recorded fatalities and serious injuries over the past five years will be flagged as a critical area for intervention.
- **High Risk Network:** Areas identified as part of the High Risk Network, even if they have not yet experienced a high number of injuries, are included to proactively mitigate future dangers. For example, intersections with poor visibility and heavy traffic flow would score highly under this criterion.
- **Bicycle and Pedestrian High Risk:** Specific focus is given to locations that pose significant risks to pedestrians and bicycles. For instance, a school zone or commercial area with inadequate crossing infrastructure would score highly.
- **Motorcyclist User High Risk:** Specific focus is given to locations that pose significant risks to motorcyclists based on existing crash occurrence.
- **Previous Plan Priorities:** Consideration is given to the relevant importance of corridors identified in previous improvement plans. For instance, a project with component projects that were high-priority in their respective plans would be weighted favorably.
- **Readiness:** Strategies and projects that can be implemented quickly, relative to right-of-way needs, National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) impacts, or outside coordination, will be prioritized. This criteria will allow Colorado Springs to focus on projects with the highest chance of being completed quickly and within the grant timelines.
- **Local Preference:** This allows City decision makers to consider alignment with other, non-safety related goals like benefiting key destinations or critical corridors.

Criteria Application

Each criterion is assigned a weight to quantify its importance. For example, a corridor that lies on both the LOSS Network (25 points) and HRN (20 points) and has projects that were high priority in other plans (10 points) accrues a total of 55 points. This scoring system ensures that projects addressing the most critical needs are advanced first.

Project Prioritization Scenario

Consider an intersection near a local park and school that has recorded numerous pedestrian crashes and has garnered repeated community complaints. It is located on the LOSS Network, Bicycle and Pedestrian HRN, and has been highlighted in past traffic improvement plans. Based on these overlapping criteria, this intersection would receive high priority for safety enhancements such as upgraded crosswalks, signal timing adjustments, and improved lighting.

This structured approach ensures resources are allocated effectively, targeting areas with the highest risk and community impact.

TABLE 6.2 Colorado Springs Prioritization Criteria and Weighting		
Criteria	Weight	Scoring Rubric
Fatal and Injury LOSS Network	25	On the network (Full) Partially on the network (Half) Limited network overlap (None)
High Risk Network	20	On the network (Full) Partially on the network (Half) Limited network overlap (None)
Bicycle and Pedestrian High Risk	15	Within existing “crash zone” (Full) Partially in existing “crash zone” (Half) Limited existing “crash zone” overlap (None)
Motorcycle High Risk	15	Within existing “crash zone” (Full) Partially in existing “crash zone” (Half) Limited existing “crash zone” overlap (None)
Previous Plan Priorities	10	High (Full) Medium (Half) Low (None)
Readiness	10	High (Full) Medium (Half) Low (None)
Local Preference	5	Near key destination node and critical corridor (Full) Critical corridors or near key destination (Half) Outside both (None)

Funding and Grant Opportunities

Securing funding for transportation safety improvements is often a major challenge, but this Plan helps overcome that barrier by clearly demonstrating the urgent need for infrastructure upgrades. Through comprehensive technical analyses and strong stakeholder and public engagement, the Plan positions Colorado Springs as highly competitive for external funding opportunities. By converting crash data into well defined project descriptions, the City is effectively “project ready” and able to show due diligence to potential funders. This data driven foundation strengthens eligibility for key programs such as the HSIP, SS4A, and SRTS.

Beyond prioritizing implementation projects, the Plan provides detailed project descriptions and cost estimates that further establish Colorado Springs as prepared to pursue funding. Its combination of rigorous traffic and collision analysis with meaningful public input ensures that complex safety challenges are translated into actionable solutions. With these elements in place, the City is equipped with the essential groundwork needed to compete for and secure highly competitive grant funding.

Central to the Plan’s funding strategy is identifying locations with high crash-reduction potential, specifically those designated as fatal and injury LOSS 3 or 4. This technical focus strengthens Colorado Springs’s ability to score favorably in federal and state discretionary grant programs, ensuring eligibility for SS4A implementation dollars and other sources. For major federal grants, bundling multiple priority projects into a single application can maximize investment and demonstrate broader benefits. In contrast, smaller state-managed grants may support targeted components such as intersection upgrades (HSIP) or sidewalk construction (SRTS). In the context of Colorado’s budget shortfalls and increased competition for limited funds, strategic phasing and careful alignment with grant criteria will be crucial to successful project implementation.



TABLE 6.3 Funding Watch List for Grant Pursuits		
Grant Program Link + Key Dates	Project Types	Funding Details and Considerations
U.S. DOT Safe Streets and Roads for ALL (SS4A) Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) Grant Program US Department of Transportation The expected due date is Quarter 2 or 3 of the calendar year.	Implementation grants will award funds for eligible projects identified in approved SS4A SAPs.	Funding Range: \$2,500,000 to \$25,000,000 for implementation (final design and construction) projects Match: 20% local (non-federal) Federal Fiscal Year 2026 is the final year of funding for this program under the historic Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA). Additional appropriations could be authorized.
Better Utilizing Investments to Leverage Development (BUILD-formerly RAISE and TIGER) Better Utilizing Investments to Leverage Development (BUILD) Grant Program US Department of Transportation The expected due date is Quarter 1 of the calendar year.	Surface transportation infrastructure projects with significant local or regional impact.	Funding Range: \$1,000,000–\$25,000,000 for capital projects; minimum \$5,000,000 for urban capital projects Match: 20% local (non-federal) share required, but rural projects may qualify for reduced match requirements Special Rural Set-Aside: 50% of BUILD funds were reserved for rural projects in the prior cycle.
Multimodal Discretionary Grant Program (MDGP) – Rural Surface Transportation Grant MPDG Program U.S. Department of Transportation The expected due date is Quarter 2 of the calendar year.	Highway, bridge, and tunnel projects eligible under federal programs (including high-risk rural roads).	Funding Range: 10% of total program funds are reserved for small projects under \$25 million; no stated minimum or maximum “request amounts” Match: 20% generally but, may be waived for rural communities
Highway Safety Improvement Program (HSIP) Highway Safety Improvement Program — Colorado Department of Transportation The expected due date is Quarter 1 of the calendar year.	HSIP awards funds to cost-effective countermeasures to address documented (data-driven) safety issues, including intersection safety, roadway departure prevention, and pedestrian/bicycle safety. This is a core FHWA program managed through CDOT.	Funding Range: Minimum \$250,000 per application Match: 10% local (90% federal share)
Safe Routes to Schools (SRTS) Safe Routes to School — Colorado Department of Transportation The expected due date is Quarter 2 or 3 of the calendar year.	Funds programs and projects that benefit K-12 schoolchildren. Projects must be within a two-mile radius of the identified school(s).	Funding Range: (infrastructure) \$100,000 to \$1 million Match: 20% local

TABLE 6.3 Funding Watch List for Grant Pursuits (Continued)		
Grant Program Link + Key Dates	Project Types	Funding Details and Considerations
Surface Transportation Block Grant (STBG) and other regionally managed federal funds Call for Projects - PPACG The expected due date is Quarter 1 of the calendar year.	Highway/bridge construction, public road safety improvements (traffic signalization, guardrails), transit capital projects, bicycle and pedestrian infrastructure, and transportation planning activities.	Funding Range: Varies by region; typically \$500,000–\$20,000,000 for major metro projects Match: 20% local (80% federal share) STBG federal funds are administered through PPACG typically include set asides for Transportation Alternatives (TA) bike and pedestrian projects, and emissions reductions, Congestion Mitigation and Air Quality and the Carbon Reduction Program (CMAQ and CRP).
Revitalizing Main Streets (RMS) Revitalizing Main Streets — Colorado Department of Transportation This program is paused.	Funds active transportation infrastructure improvements that support downtown vitality, economic development, community access to public streets, and multimodal transportation.	Funding Range: up to \$250,000 Match: 10% local Funding is currently “paused” due to Colorado budget shortfalls.
Multimodal Transportation and Mitigation Options Fund (MMOF) Multimodal Transportation and Mitigation Options Fund (MMOF) — Colorado Department of Transportation The next call for projects is expected in 2027 (every other year).	Larger capital or planning projects that reduce vehicle miles traveled. Funds multimodal transportation projects that: • Provide safe routes to school • Enhance mobility for seniors and persons with disabilities • Benefit rural and disproportionately impacted communities	Funding Range: Varies by region; typically \$500,000–\$20,000,000 for major metro projects Match: 50% local CDOT provides the program guidelines and funding allocations, but applications are submitted to PPACG, which then submits approved projects to CDOT for final inclusion in the Statewide Transportation Improvement Program (STIP).
Energy and Mineral Impact Assistance Fund (EIAF) administered by the Department of Local Affairs (DOLA) Energy/Mineral Impact Assistance Fund Grant (EIAF) Division of Local Government The expected due date is Q4 of the calendar year.	Assists political subdivisions impacted by the development, processing, or energy conversion of minerals and mineral fuels. El Paso County is eligible and would need to serve as the applicant and “pass through” funding to Colorado Springs or manage the project implementation and grant reporting.	Funding Range: Tier 1 projects up to \$200,000; Tier 2 projects are highly competitive, and funding is up to \$1 million Match: 50%

What about Earmarks?

Congressionally Directed Spending (U.S. Senate) and Community Project Funding (U.S. House), known as “earmarks,” let Congress members request direct federal funds for local projects via annual appropriations bills. Reinstated in Fiscal Year 2022, these programs fund state and local initiatives such as infrastructure, public safety, education, and economic development.

Key Points

- Eligible applicants are state and local governments. The process involves meetings with Congressional staff, a project summary sheet, and early-year submissions (February–March).
- Projects must match existing federal programs and meet legal criteria.
- Approved requests are included in appropriations; agencies distribute funds as grants or agreements.
- Compliance with federal grant regulations is required.
- Final funding depends on the federal budget, with disbursement typically taking 12–18 months.
- Projects under \$2 million and ready to launch have the best chance of approval.

Action Items for Successful Funding Strategies

The recommendations below are designed to support the development of a successful funding strategy.

Submit priority projects (identified in *Appendix D*) for inclusion in the State and Federal Transportation Improvement Program (TIP). Most grants that include federal funding (even when administered through the state) require that projects be listed in the TIP.

Identify revenue sources and budget for local match funding and funding technical support. While Colorado Springs has a qualified grant professional on staff, additional technical support from a contractor or subject matter expert may be needed for more complex grant applications that require a benefit-cost analysis for specific federal grant applications. Most grants require local matching funds. Local tools for revenue generation, such as development impact fees, sales tax, property tax, TIF, user fees, and General Fund dollars, may need to be considered.

Begin advocacy efforts to state and federal elected officials to explain the need for the priority projects and to garner political support for discretionary grants and/or “earmarks” Congressionally Directed Spending and Community Project Funding. It is also highly beneficial to contact state and regional agencies to alert them to your needs and intentions to apply for upcoming grants. This ensures you are on the agency’s mailing lists. Some staff (DOLA) even review your project scope, budget, and narrative approach and provide recommendations to maximize your score.

Budget for “self-funding” lower-cost/high-impact improvements identified in the SAP, such as signage and pavement markings. The City should coordinate with CDOT and utilities to implement safety measures when resurfacing or maintenance projects are underway.

Performance Measures and Tracking

Creating a safer environment for all road users is a central goal of this Plan. To achieve this, the Plan establishes clear, quantifiable performance measures that evaluate the effectiveness of safety initiatives and guide ongoing improvements. These measures—such as the number of crashes reported, progress on projects, and successes in policy and partnership implementation—enable the City to determine whether safety goals are being met and where further action is needed.

Accountability and continuous improvement are ensured through regular tracking of these metrics, using both manual logs and digital systems, in particular the City’s new SafeStreetsCOS dashboard. Both the City of Colorado Springs Public Works and the Working Group are responsible for data collection and review, with scheduled reporting and established benchmarks to gauge progress. The analysis of collected data helps identify trends, successes, and areas for improvement, and results are shared with stakeholders through periodic reports and dashboards. This transparent approach supports informed decision-making and timely adjustments to the Plan.

The Plan highlights that severe crashes in Colorado Springs are disproportionately concentrated at intersections, on arterial roadways, and in socially vulnerable areas. Vulnerable road users—including pedestrians, bicyclists, and motorcyclists—face significantly higher risks, with contributing factors such as speed, impairment, and context (medians, activity centers, transit stops) playing major roles. By adopting a Safe System Approach and monitoring appropriate performance metrics, the City can focus resources where they will have the greatest impact on reducing severe injuries and fatalities.

The City will monitor progress on the Plan by using the metrics on the following page.

How to Use the Performance Metrics

Set Baselines

Use analysis from this Plan to establish current values for each metric.

Maintain Data

Monitor and update data (crashes, implementation progress, etc.)

Update Analysis

Refresh specific analyses as well as data within the SafeStreetsCOS Dashboard to ensure accurate tracking of progress.

Report Publicly

Share progress with stakeholders and the community to maintain transparency and accountability through regular updates of the SafeStreetsCOS webpage.

1. Crash Outcome Metrics

- **Annual Number of Fatal and Serious Injury Crashes:** The total and year-over-year change in severe crashes citywide to realize the goal of 35% reduction from 2023.
- **Crash Rate by Mode:** Severe crashes for pedestrians, bicyclists, and motorcyclists, monitored separately from motor vehicle occupants, to show continuous downward trends that track as well or better than overall crash reduction.
- **Crash Rate by Type:** Severe intersection crashes—particularly broadside and approach-turn collisions, which are most strongly linked to severe outcomes—to achieve consistent year-over-year declines.

2. Location-Based Metrics

- **HRN Crash Share:** Percentage of all severe crashes occurring on the identified High-Risk Network.
- **Intersection vs. Non-Intersection Crashes:** The proportion and trends of severe crashes at intersections, driveways, and mid-block locations to show a consistent year-over-year reduction.

3. Behavioral and Contributing Factor Metrics

- **Impaired Driving Involvement:** Percentage of fatal and serious injury crashes involving driver impairment (alcohol, drugs) to show a consistent year-over-year reduction.
- **Speed-Related Severe Crashes:** Number and proportion of severe crashes occurring on corridors with posted speeds ≥40 mph, and those where speed was a contributing factor to show a consistent year-over-year reduction.
- **Helmet and Seatbelt Usage Rates:** For motorcyclists and vehicle occupants, the percentage of severe crashes where helmets or seatbelts were not used.
- **Behavioral Observations:** Periodic studies of speed compliance, yielding at crosswalks, and other key safety behaviors.

4. Social Vulnerability Metrics

- **Severe Crashes in High Social Vulnerability Areas:** The percentage and rate of severe crashes in census tracts with high SVI scores.
- **Severe Crashes Near Transit Stops and Activity Centers:** The number and share of severe crashes within a two-minute walk of transit stops and major activity centers.

5. Implementation Metrics

- **Infrastructure Improvements Completed:** Total number and construction cost of projects implemented.
- **Programs, Partnerships, and Policies (PPP):** Progress towards implementing PPP initiatives, measured qualitatively by the initiative’s status.

6. Community and Perception Metrics

- **Community Perception of Safety:** Survey results on how safe people feel walking, biking, or driving, especially in high-risk and high-vulnerability areas.

